

English Guide @ Level B1/B2

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Abstract

Built by Carmen Crai covering tenses, prepositions, adverbs, modal verbs, linking words and more, up to B2 level.

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EASY AND PRACTICAL GUIDE

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1. Start

This course is built around the priorities below — the grammar and vocabulary areas that make the biggest difference to how clearly and confidently you communicate in English.

1. [Grammar](#): present, past and future tenses (simple, continuous, passive, perfect)
2. [Prepositions](#): at, in, on, about, for, by, with
3. [Adverbs](#): words ending in “ly” that usually describe **how** an action is done
4. [Comparison adjectives](#): six types (equality, inequality, comparative, superlative...)
5. [Possessives](#): 's / s' and **possessive** pronouns (mine, yours, theirs, his, hers)
6. [Linking words](#): to **connect ideas** clearly (see the Linking Words chapter)
7. [The gerund](#) ing form: as a **noun** and after prepositions
8. [Verbs \(V3\) that become adjectives](#), and **nouns** that act as **adjectives**
9. [Modal verbs](#): can, could, would, should, must, may, might
10. **Professional** / workplace verbs and vocabulary — see [Appendix J — Extended Professional Words Table](#)
11. **At B1/B2** level you must be able to **easily provide synonyms**: for verbs, adjectives, adverbs, linking words and nouns.

2. Grammar: Tenses

In a professional workplace, I only recommend the below grammar to be used:

SIMPLE									
PRESENT		Action in the present taking place regularly, never or several times .				To be (am/are/is) verb describes a person/animal/object : adjectives, job, nationality, location, feelings, presence.			
		A: He speaks . They speak . N: He doesn't speak. They don't speak. Q: Does he speak? Do they speak? Q-: Doesn't he speak? Does he not speak?				A: He is here/good/German. They are great. N: He isn't here/good/German. He is not here/good. They aren't great. They are not great. Q+: Is he here? Are they good people? Q-: Isn't he German? Is he not here? Aren't they here yet? Are they not here yet?			
		I				I	am		
		You	V1			You	are		
		She/He/It	V1			She/He/It	is		
		We	V1+s/es/ies			We	are		
		They	V1			They	are		
SIMPLE PASSIVE									
		Focus is on the action , not on the person/doing.							
		A: The task is done. The contract is signed. N: The task is not / isn't done. The contract isn't signed. The contract is not signed yet. Q+: Is the task done? Q-: Isn't the contract signed? Is the contract not signed yet?							
		I		am		I	am		
		You	V1	are		You	are		
		She/He/It	V1	is	V3	She/He/It	is		
		We	V1+s/es/ies	are		We	are		
		They	V1	are		They	are		
CONTINUOUS									
		Action taking place now that takes time .							
		A: He is speaking. They are speaking. N: He is not / isn't speaking. They are not speaking. Is he speaking? Are they speaking? Q-: Aren't they speaking? Are they not speaking?							
		I		am		I	am		
		You	V1	are		You	are		
		She/He/It	V1	is	V3	She/He/It	is		
		We	V1+s/es/ies	are		We	are		
		They	V1	are		They	are		
PERFECT									
		Finished action that has an influence on the present .							
		A: He has spoken. They have spoken. N: He has not spoken. They haven't spoken. Q+: Has he spoken? Have they spoken? Q-: Hasn't he spoken? Has he not spoken? Haven't they spoken? Have they not spoken?							
		I		have		I	have		
		You	V1	has		You	has		
		She/He/It	V1	has	V3	She/He/It	has		
		We	V1+s/es/ies	have		We	have		
		They	V1	have		They	have		
PERFECT CONTINUOUS									
		Action that started in the past and it continues now .							
		A: He has been speaking. They have been speaking. N: He hasn't been speaking. They haven't been speaking. Q+: Has he been speaking? Have they been speaking? Q-: Hasn't he been speaking? Has he not been speaking? Haven't they been speaking? Have they not been talking?							
		I		have		I	have		
		You	V1	has		You	has		
		She/He/It	V1	has	V3	She/He/It	has		
		We	V1+s/es/ies	been	V1-ing	We	been		
		They	V1	have		They	have		
PAST									
		Action in the past taking place once, never or several times.				Focus is on the action , not on the person who does it.			
		A: He spoke . They spoke . N: He didn't speak. They didn't speak. Q: Did he speak? Did they speak? Did he not speak? Did they not speak?				A: The task was done. The contract was signed. N: The task was not / wasn't done. The contract was not / wasn't signed. Q+: Was the task done? Q-: Wasn't the contract signed? Was the contract not signed yet?			
		I		was		I	was		
		You	V2	were		You	were		
		She/He/It	V2	were	V3	She/He/It	were		
		We	V2+s/es/ies	were		We	were		
		They	V2	were		They	were		
FUTURE									
		Planned action in the future.				Focus is on the action , not on the person/doing.			
		A: He will speak. They will speak. N: He won't speak. They won't speak. Q: Will he speak? Will they speak? Q-: Won't he speak? Will he not speak?				A: The task will be done. The contract will be signed. N: The task will not be / won't be done. The contract will not be / won't be signed. Q+: Will the task be done? Q-: Won't the contract be signed? Will the contract not be signed?			
		I		will		I	will		
		You	V1	be	V3	You	be		
		She/He/It	V1	will		She/He/It	will		
		We	V1+s/es/ies	be		We	be		
		They	V1	will		They	will		
FUTURE CONTINUOUS									
		Action that is going on at a certain time in the future.				Focus is on the action , not on the person/doing.			
		A: He will be speaking. They will be speaking. N: He won't be speaking. They won't be speaking. Q: Will he be speaking? Will they be speaking? Q-: Won't they be speaking? Will they not be speaking?				A: He will be speaking. They will be speaking. N: He won't be speaking. They won't be speaking. Q: Will he be speaking? Will they be speaking? Q-: Won't they be speaking? Will they not be speaking?			
		I		will		I	will		
		You	V1	be	V3	You	be		
		She/He/It	V1	will		She/He/It	will		
		We	V1+s/es/ies	be		We	be		
		They	V1	will		They	will		

For further information, see [Appendix A — Extended Tenses Table](#).

3. Prepositions

Prepositions link nouns, pronouns or gerunds to the rest of the sentence. The three most common are at, in and on, used for time and place.

We arrived at the station at 6 p.m. (precise time / point)

She was born in 1990 and lives in London. (year / city — larger area)

The meeting is on Monday, on the 5th floor. (day / surface)

Further usage:

When	In
parts of the day	☐ in the morning/afternoon/evening
months	☐ in January/February
seasons	☐ in (the) spring/summer/autumn/winter
years, centuries, decades	☐ in 2016 ☐ in the 21st century ☐ in the 80s
other time phrases	☐ in the past ☐ in the future ☐ in the last few years/months/weeks/days

When	On
days	☐ on Monday/Tuesday etc. ☐ on my birthday ☐ on New Year's Day ☐ On weekend
dates	☐ on 30 July ☐ on the second of August

When	At
clock times	☐ at 6 o'clock ☐ at 9.30 ☐ at 13.00
meal times and breaks	☐ at breakfast time ☐ at lunchtime ☐ at dinner time ☐ at break time
other time phrases	☐ at night ☐ at weekends/the weekend ☐ at Christmas/Easter

For **further prepositions** information, see [Appendix G — Extended Prepositions Notes](#).

4. Adverbs

Adverbs usually end in -ly and describe how an action is done (they modify a verb, adjective or another adverb). Word order matters: Front position for time/linking words, Mid position (between subject and verb) for frequency, End position for place and time. With several adverbs together, the order is Manner → Place → Time → Purpose.

She speaks clearly. (manner)

He often works late. (frequency, mid position)

He worked hard in the garden yesterday to finish the project. (manner → place → time → purpose)

Full placement rules and exceptions (with more examples) are collected in [Appendix E — Extended Adverbs Table](#).

If there is an action verb, then use the adverb before the verb, otherwise at the end of the idea/topic.

If you are unsure where to put an adverb with an action verb, the safest spot is the very **end of the sentence/idea** — it's almost always correct there.

Below there is a list with the most commonly **misunderstood** adverbs:

Let's put frequency and manner adverbs into practice — this table shows exactly where each one belongs in a sentence.

Adverb	Meaning & Example	Adverb	Meaning & Example
Deep	Deep (physical): <i>They dug deep.</i>	Deeply	Deep (emotions): <i>I am deeply moved.</i>
Direct	Without stopping / Straight / Immediate: <i>Go direct to Paris.</i>	Directly	Immediately / Direct: <i>Call me directly.</i>

Adverb	Meaning & Example	Adverb	Meaning & Example
Fair	Fair (by the rules): <i>Play fair!</i>	Fairly	Quite / Somewhat / Fairly: <i>It was fairly easy.</i>
High	High up (physical): <i>The bird flew high.</i>	Highly	Very / Extremely: <i>He is a highly skilled individual.</i>
Hard	Hard / Intensely: <i>She works hard.</i>	Hardly	Barely / Hardly at all: <i>She hardly works.</i>
Late	Late (in time): <i>I arrived late.</i>	Lately	Recently / Lately: <i>I haven't seen him lately.</i>
Like (prep.)	Similar: <i>I am like you.</i>	Likely	High probability: <i>It is likely for the economy to increase.</i>
Near	Near (distance): <i>The cat sat near.</i>	Nearly	Almost / Approximately: <i>I nearly missed it.</i>
Short	Abruptly / Short: <i>The car stopped short.</i>	Shortly	Soon: <i>We will start shortly.</i>
Wide	Wide / Fully: <i>Open your mouth wide.</i>	Widely	Widely / Generally: <i>It is widely used.</i>

Are you able to **differentiate** which one is: verb, noun, adjectives and adverbs from the examples below?

DECIDE -> DECISION -> DECISIVE -> DECISIVELY,
 CLARIFY -> CLARITY -> CLEAR -> CLEARLY,
 IMPROVE -> EFFICIENCY -> EFFICIENT -> EFFICIENTLY.

For the full verb / noun / adjective / adverb word-family table ->
 see [Appendix E — Extended Adverbs Table](#).

5. Comparison Adjectives

English has several ways to compare things: equality (as...as), inequality (not as...as), comparative (-er / more...than), and superlative (the -est / the most...).

Type	Formula	Explanation	Example
Level 0: Equality	as + adjective + as	Two things, people, groups, countries, days, reports, experiences are the same.	Tom is as tall as Ben.
Level 0: Inequality	not as + adjective + as		Tom is not as tall as Ben.

Type	Formula	Explanation	Example
Level 1: Comparative	Short adjectives (~ less than 6 letters): -er + than	Two things, people, groups, countries, days, reports, experiences are the same.	Tom is taller than Ben.
Level 1: Comparative	Long adjectives (~ more than 6 letter): more + adjective + than		Gold is more expensive than silver.
The comparison is done with a GROUP/city/department/country/all my life/previous days/reports			
Level +2: Superlative	the + -est	The most in a group.	Tom is the tallest in the class.
Level +2: Superlative	the most + adjective		This is the most important lesson.
Level -1: Comparative (less)	less + adjective + than	Less of something (uncountable :money, time, energy, love).	This task is less difficult than that one.
Level -1: Comparative (fewer)	fewer + noun + than	The comparison is with two: things/people/groups/countries/days/ reports/experiences Fewer things (countable: tasks, emails, clients, books).	I have fewer books than you.
The comparison is done with a GROUP/city/department/country/all my life/previous days/reports			
Level -2: Superlative (least)	the least + adjective	The least (uncountable). The fewest (countable).	This is the least useful tool.
Level -2: Superlative (fewest)	the fewest + noun		She has the fewest mistakes.

For the full comparison-adjectives reference (with common mistakes to avoid), see [Appendix D — Extended Comparison Adjectives Table](#).

6. Possessives

Use 's after a singular noun (or an irregular plural) to show possession, and just an apostrophe after a regular plural noun. Possessive pronouns (mine, yours, his, hers, theirs) replace a possessive adjective + noun.

Form	Explanation	Example
Genitive ('s) — singular	Add 's directly after the owner (person/living entity).	This is Tom's amazing tablet.
Genitive (of)	Use when the owner is a non-living object, a place, or a concept.	The end of the street.
Possessive ' — plural	If something belongs to more than one person, add ' after the plural s.	Our friends' house is in the mountains.
Possessive 's — irregular plural	If the plural noun is irregular (doesn't end in -s), add 's.	This is our children's school.
Shared possession	All people share the same car/book/house.	Andrea, Iulia and Alex's car/book/house is there.
Individual possession	Each person has a car/book/house.	Andrea's, Iulia's and Alex's car/book/house is there.
Possessive adjectives/pronouns	Replace or determine a noun to show a relationship: my/mine, your/yours, his, her/hers, our/ours, their/theirs.	This is my boss's office. / That desk is mine.

7. Modal Verbs

Modal verbs add meaning — ability, obligation, possibility or politeness — to a main verb, which always stays in its base form. In a professional environment, several modals (would, could, should) are also the standard way to sound polite and formal.

Never use **to** after a modal verb. For e.g.: I must **to** learn English.

There is only one exception for **ought to** = **have to** (mandatory), but this is rarely used in practice.

Modal verbs change the meaning of a whole sentence. Here's a friendly overview of the most useful ones.

Modal	Explanation	Used for:	Examples
CAN	can / know how to	ability, possibility, informal permission	I can drive. She can speak English.
COULD	could / would be able to	past ability, possibility, polite requests	I could swim when I was 5. Could you help me?
WOULD	would	conditional, politeness, preferences	I would like a coffee. I would like to discuss this topic.
SHOULD	should	recommendations, advice, opinions	You should study every day. We should increase the safety stock.
NEED TO	need to	practical necessity (self-imposed)	I need to call the supplier. We need to update the planning file.
HAVE TO	have to	obligation imposed by a rule, procedure or situation	I had to wear a badge at work. We have to follow customer requirements.
MUST	must / absolutely have to	very strong, mandatory obligation	You must wear a helmet. I must finish this report.
MAY	it is possible / may	possibility, formal permission	It may rain tomorrow. May I come in?
MIGHT	might / maybe	weaker possibility	The supplier might be late. We might have a shortage next month.

For further information, see [Appendix B — Extended Modal Verbs Table](#).

8. Linking Words

Linking words connect ideas and make your writing and speech flow logically — for introducing, adding, contrasting, giving a result, or concluding.

Category	Linking words
Introduction	First / Firstly, First of all, To begin with, In the beginning, Before that
Addition	And, Also, In addition, As well as, Furthermore, Moreover, Too
Example	For example, For instance, Such as, Like
Comparison	Similarly, Likewise, In the same way, Equally
Contrast	But, However, Yet, Still, Although, Even though, Despite, On the other hand, Whereas, In contrast
Cause	Because, Since, As, Due to, Owing to, Because of
Result	So, Therefore, As a result, Consequently, Thus, Hence
Time / sequence	Then, After, Afterwards, Following this, Meanwhile, At the same time, In the long run
Ending	Finally, Lastly, In the end
Summary	In summary, To summarize, In general
Conclusion	To conclude, All things considered, On balance, All in all
Exception	Except for, Apart from, Except

For further information, see [Appendix C — Extended Linking Words Table](#).

9. Articles — The

The is the definite article and is used for **something specific** or already **known** to the listener. If there is a **general** idea/ **topic**/ **abstract** then, **do not use** the. The is the same for all genders, singular and plural: the boy, the girl, the cat, the computers.

- ✓ Proper nouns are generally used without an article, because they are already clearly defined (e.g. Romania, Information, Data).
- ✓ Seasons can be used with or without the: in summer / in the summer — both are correct.
- ✓ The American English word fall is always used with the definite article: in the fall.
- ✓ The is usually used for famous buildings and sights, but there are exceptions.
- ✓ Whether to use the often depends on context/purpose: The student goes to school (school for its normal purpose — no article) vs. The mother is going to the school (a specific school, for a different reason — use the).

Examples:

The student goes to school. (school in general — no article needed for the purpose). Work is important nowadays. HR / IT responded to the email.

The mother is going to the/a British school. (a specific school) . The HR/ IT team / department has responded to the email. (a specific team/department)

We often play tennis in (the) summer.

10. Gerund vs. Infinitive

The gerund (-ing form) works like a noun (similar to gerund forms in many other languages).

Noun example: Listening to you I realized ... / Knowing you came I cleaned.../

Gerund example: *She is good at solving problems.*

Noun example: *Listening to you I realized a,b,c. / Reading is fun.*

There are certain prepositions after which a gerund verb (v-ing) follows such as:

Some prepositions are always followed by the -ing form — here's a handy list of examples.

Preposition	Example
Without	Mark played the piano without making any mistakes.
After	After reading the textbook, Jimmy did his homework.
Before	Put on your boots before taking a hike.
By	I passed the test by studying very hard.
Instead of	Why don't you go out instead of sitting at home?
In spite of	Amy went to work in spite of feeling ill.
About	We talked about moving abroad.
For	Thanks for helping me.
Of	She is afraid of flying .
At	He is great at cooking .
In	She is interested in traveling .
To*	I look forward to seeing you soon.
To	I look forward to the party (noun).

For more notes on gerunds vs. infinitives, see [Appendix H — Extended Gerund Notes](#).

To versus Verb-ing

Not sure whether to use *to* or *-ing*? This table breaks down the rules with clear examples.

Rule	Explanation	Example
Intent / Plans	After verbs like <i>want, decide, hope, plan</i> .	I want to play tennis.
After Prepositions	After any preposition (<i>of, about, by, for, in</i>).	He is tired of playing .
Enjoyment	After verbs of preference like <i>enjoy, dislike, fancy</i> .	I enjoy playing the piano.
Purpose (Why?)	To express a reason or an objective.	I came here to play .
Subject of Sentence	When the activity itself is the subject.	Playing is good for kids.
After sentiment verbs for e.g.: Like, Dislike, Love, Enjoy, Prefer, Hate	Can use both; <i>-ing</i> emphasizes the experience.	I love playing .

11. Conditionals

Conditional sentences describe cause-and-effect situations that are real, possible, or imaginary — the four types below, with professional examples, range from A2–B1 to B2–C1.

Conditional Type	Level	When It Is Used	Professional Example
First Conditional	A2–B1	Real and likely future situations	If we approve the budget, the project will start.
Second Conditional	B1	Hypothetical or unlikely present/future	If we had more resources, we would expand faster.
Third Conditional	B2	Hypothetical past situations	If we had acted earlier, we would have avoided losses.
Mixed Conditional	B2–C1	Past condition affecting a present result	If we had invested sooner, we would be market leaders now.

12. Phonetics

Phonetic transcriptions (IPA) show you exactly how a word is pronounced, no matter how it is spelled. Every verb in Appendix F includes its IPA transcription in slashes, e.g. /spi:k/ for speak. Here is a quick guide to the symbols you will see most often.

Please go to [IPA](#) and click on each letter/character and practice sounds.

Phonemic Chart

Click on each letter to HEAR the sound and repeat after.

/i:/	/ɪ/	/e/	/æ/	/ʌ/	/ɑ:/	/ɔ:/	/ʊ/	/u:/	/ʊ/	/ɪ/	/e/	/æ/	/ʌ/	/ɑ:/
sheep	kit	bed	cat	cup	car	boat	book	food	cup	wait	bed	cat	cup	car

Need a fast refresher on tenses? This table lines them all up side by side so you can find the right form in seconds.

Symbol	Sounds like	Example
/i:/	ee as in see	see → /si:/
/ɪ/	short i as in sit	sit → /sɪt/
/e/	e as in bed	bed → /bed/
/æ/	short a as in cat	cat → /kæt/
/ɑ:/	long ah as in car	car → /kɑ:r/
/ɒ/	short o as in hot	hot → /hɒt/
/ɔ:/	aw as in bought	bought → /bɔ:t/
/ʊ/	short oo as in book	book → /bʊk/
/u:/	long oo as in food	food → /fu:d/
/ʌ/	uh as in cup	cup → /kʌp/
/ɜ:/	ur as in bird	bird → /bɜ:rd/
/ə/	aaaa	about → /ə'baʊt/
/ʃ/	sh as in shop	shop → /ʃɒp/
/ʒ/	zh as in vision	vision → /'vɪʒn/
/tʃ/	ch as in chair	chair → /tʃeə/
/dʒ/	j as in job	job → /dʒɒb/
/θ/	unvoiced th as in think	think → /θɪŋk/
/ð/	voiced th as in this	this → /ðɪs/
/ŋ/	ng as in sing	sing → /sɪŋ/
/j/	y as in yes	yes → /jes/

The mark ' shows the start of the stressed syllable, e.g. about → /ə'baʊt/ (stress on the second syllable).

For the full phonetic transcription of every verb in this course, see [Appendix F — Extended Irregular Verbs Table](#).

13. Irregular and regular Verbs

Irregular verbs don't follow the -ed pattern in the past. For example: speak v1 spoke v2 spoken v3

While, regular verbs end in -ed in the past. For e.g.: work v1 worked v2 worked v3

Where:

V1 = present

V2 = past simple

V3 = **perfect/passive** grammar + verbs that may become **adjectives**

Below there is a small sample of regular and irregular verbs:

Linking words are the glue of fluent writing. Here is the full set, organized so you can pick the right connector every time.

Curious how a word actually sounds? This table matches each symbol to a familiar sound.

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Perfect/Passive /Adjectives v3	Phonetics
Accept	/ək'sept/	Accepted	/ək'septɪd/	Accepted	/ək'septɪd/
Buy	/baɪ/	Bought	/bɔ:t/	Bought	/bɔ:t/
Call	/kɔ:l/	Called	/kɔ:ld/	Called	/kɔ:ld/
Can	/kæn/	Could	/kʊd/	Could	/kʊd/
Catch	/kætf/	Caught	/kɔ:t/	Caught	/kɔ:t/

For further information, see [Appendix F — Extended Irregular and Regular Verbs Table](#).

14. Practical Exercises

Find and correct the error in each B2-level sentence below. The exercise covers comparison adjectives, double negation, modal verbs, conditionals, adverbs, linking words, prepositions, -ing/-ed adjectives, and -ing nouns, on the topics of software testing, quality, AI, business, and a beautiful life.

Run queries on your own at least 50 per week.

For e.g. in Chrome open AI agent:

create a table and add 50 English error correction / (ADD LANGUAGE translations to english) with multiple errors in: verbs, grammar, comparison adjectives like: equality, inequality, er + than, more + than, less than, the least, fewer than, the fewest, in double negation, modal verbs, if cases, adverbs, adjectives, linking words and wrong prepositions to B2 level, add ?-, ?+, -, + , use nouns ending in "ing", for e.g. understanding, add adjectives ending in "ing" and "ed" , add adjectives derived from verbs for e.g. "the required data". Use the topic: sys/sw testing, quality, AI, business, a beautiful life. Add the translations and hints. Use the words: ADD Professional verbs from [Appendix J Extended Professional Verbs Table](#).

Open an AI Agent:

Write:
create a table and add 20 English error correction with multiple errors in: verbs, grammar, comparison adjectives like: equality, inequality, er + than, more + than, less than, the least, fewer than, the fewest, in double negation, modal verbs, if cases, adverbs, adjectives, linking words and wrong prepositions to B2 level, add ?-, ?+, -, +, use nouns ending in "ing", for e.g. understanding, add adjectives ending in "ing" and "ed", add adjectives derived from verbs for e.g. "the required data". Use the topic: sys/sw testing, quality, AI, business, a beautiful life. Add the translations and hints. Use the words: ADD VERBE

Adapt
Adjust
Align / Allocate
Align on
Align with
Allocate
Analyze
Analyze /
Appraise /
Approve
Architect

You need to enable the AI agent in Chrome

If you do not see the buttons, you may need to add the feature on in your Google Account settings:

1. Open a new tab in Chrome and make sure you are signed into your Google Account.
2. Click the **Search Labs** icon (the beaker symbol) at the top of the page.
3. Locate **AI Mode** in the list of available experiments.
4. Toggle the switch to **On**.

Making AI Mode Your Default Search

If you want every search you type into the Chrome address bar to process through AI Mode automatically, you can set it as your default engine:

1. Click the **three dots** in the top right corner of Chrome and open **Settings**.
2. Select **Search engine** from the left menu, then click **Manage search engines and site search**.
3. Under the Site search section, click **Add**.
4. Set the name to **AI Mode** and paste the AI search URL string provided by Google.
5. Click the **three dots** next to your new entry and select **Make default**.

A few adjectives are already as strong as it gets and are not compared the usual way — here are the most common ones to watch for.

Let's put everything together — here are some real sentences to correct and learn from.

Sentence with error	Error type	Corrected sentence	Hint
The new AI tool are more efficient than the old one.	subject–verb agreement	The new AI tool is more efficient than the old one.	singular subject → is (efficient — RO: eficient)
This release is more better than the last one.	double comparative	This release is better than the last one.	never combine 'more' with an -er form
The QA team don't found no bugs during testing.	double negation	The QA team didn't find any bugs during testing.	one negative per clause (RO: niciun bug)
If the server will crash, we will lose the data.	conditional (if + will)	If the server crashes, we will lose the data.	zero/first conditional: if + present simple
She must to update the software before the demo.	modal + to	She must update the software before the demo.	modals never take 'to' (RO: trebuie să)
This is the most fewer errors we've had this quarter.	comparison of quantity	This is the fewest errors we've had this quarter.	few → fewer → the fewest
The company are testing a understanding new feature.	adjective vs. gerund-noun	The company is testing an interesting new feature.	-ing noun ('understanding') is not an adjective here
The requiring documents were not signed on time.	-ed adjective vs -ing	The required documents were not signed on time.	past-participle adjective: 'required' (asked-for)
He explained careful the testing process to the client.	adverb form	He explained the testing process carefully to the client.	manner adverb ends in -ly
The business it depends on quality, not on speed.	redundant pronoun	The business depends on quality, not on speed.	subject already stated once
We looked forward to receive the audit results.	gerund after preposition	We looked forward to receiving the audit results.	preposition 'to' + verb-ing

Sentence with error	Error type	Corrected sentence	Hint
A beautiful life is more simple than we think, isn't it.	question form / punctuation	A beautiful life is simpler than we think, isn't it?	short adjective → -er, not 'more'; add '?'
The bug it was fixed by the developer yesterday.	redundant pronoun (passive)	The bug was fixed by the developer yesterday.	passive: was + V3, no extra pronoun
She has less bugs to fix than her colleague.	few/less with countables	She has fewer bugs to fix than her colleague.	countable noun 'bugs' → fewer, not less
They didn't tested the module properly on the server.	auxiliary + past tense	They didn't test the module properly on the server.	didn't + base form, not past tense
Despite of the tight deadline, the team delivered on time.	linking word (preposition)	Despite the tight deadline, the team delivered on time.	despite is never followed by 'of'
This is the interestingest business case we reviewed.	irregular superlative	This is the most interesting business case we reviewed.	long adjectives → the most + adjective
If I would have more time, I will test every scenario.	mixed conditional	If I had more time, I would test every scenario.	second conditional: if + past simple, would + V
The manager ask always for a status update on Fridays.	adverb position (frequency)	The manager always asks for a status update on Fridays.	frequency adverb goes before the main verb
Neither the developer or the tester found the fault.	correlative conjunction	Neither the developer nor the tester found the fault.	neither ... nor (linking word pair)

For workplace and professional verbs (with meaning, example and CEFR level), see Appendix J — Extended Professional Words Table.

15. Conclusions

By working through this guide, you have practiced the full range of English tenses (including perfect and passive forms), prepositions, adverbs, modal verbs, linking words, comparison structures, articles and the gerund/infinitive contrast — the grammar that carries a learner from A2 into confident, natural B2 English. Chapter 14 gave you a hands-on error-correction exercise across the grammar covered in this course, all cross-referenced in Appendices A through J for quick review.

Quick Rules Cheat-Sheet

- ✓ Never add “to” after a modal verb: say I must learn English, not I must to learn English.
- ✓ The only common exception to the no to after modals rule is “ought to”, which behaves like “have to”.
- ✓ A verb placed immediately after a preposition must take the -ing (gerund) form: Thanks for helping me.
- ✓ Never separate a transitive verb from its direct object with an adverb (the magnet rule).

- ✓ Frequency adverbs (always, often, never...) go before the main verb, but after to be: She is usually on time.
- ✓ Adverbs like almost, barely, hardly, nearly, just, only never go at the end of a sentence.
- ✓ Use 's after a singular noun for possession, and just an apostrophe after a regular plural noun: the cat's toy vs. the students' results.
- ✓ Short adjectives (≤ 6 letters) take -er / -est; longer adjectives take more / most.
- ✓ Do not use the for general ideas or plural/uncountable nouns used in a general sense; use **“the”** for something **specific** or already known.
- ✓ Irregular verbs change form in the past (speak → spoke → spoken); regular verbs simply add -ed (work → worked → worked).

Keep practicing with real sentences using speak, do and eat — or any other verb — until the patterns feel automatic. Little and often beats a single long session.

When you're ready for the next step, revisit the Appendix tables for quick reference, and move on to more complex conditionals, reported speech and advanced vocabulary.

Appendix — Extended Reference Tables

Appendix A — Extended Tenses Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 2. Grammar: Tenses](#)

Quick-reference summary — all tenses covered in this course:

Looking for the comparative or superlative of a specific adjective? This full list has you covered, from A to Z.

Tense	Form	Usage	Example
Present Simple (A1)	V / V+s (3rd person)	Habits, routines, facts and preferences.	I speak English every day.
Present Simple Passive (A2)	am/is/are + V3	Focus on the action/receiver, not who does it.	English is spoken here.
Present Continuous (A2)	am/is/are + V-ing	Now, a temporary situation, or a future arrangement.	I am speaking to the client now.
Past Simple (A1)	V-ed / V2	A finished action in the past.	I spoke to her yesterday.
Past Simple Passive (A2)	was/were + V3	Focus on the action done to the subject, in the past.	The report was written last week.
Past Continuous (A2)	was/were + V-ing	An action in progress in the past; also polite requests.	I was speaking when you called.
Future Simple — will (A2)	will + V	Future decisions and predictions.	I will speak to the manager tomorrow.
Future Continuous (B1)	will be + V-ing	An action in progress at a specific future time.	I will be speaking at 10 a.m. tomorrow.

Present Perfect (B1)	have/has + V3	A past action with a result or relevance now.	I have spoken to the client already.
Past Perfect (B1)	had + V3	An action before another past action; also regrets with if.	I had spoken to her before the meeting started.
Future Simple Passive (B1)	will be + V3	A future action done to the subject; focus on the event.	The results will be announced next week.
Present Perfect Continuous (B2)	have/has been + V-ing	Started in the past, still continuing; focus on duration.	I have been speaking with the team all morning.

Present Simple (A1)

Form: V / V+s (3rd person singular)

Habits, routines, facts and preferences.

Speak — I speak English every day.

Do/Done — She does her homework every evening.

Eat — They eat breakfast at 7 a.m.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I speak English every day. | She: She speaks English every day.

Negative — I: I don't speak English every day. | She: She doesn't speak English every day.

Question — I: Do I speak English every day? | She: Does she speak English every day?

Present Simple Passive (A2)

Form: am / is / are + V3

Focus on the action or the receiver, not on who does it. Also used for polite conversation.

Speak — English is spoken all over the world.

Do/Done — The work is done by the team.

Eat — Breakfast is eaten at 7 a.m.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I am spoken to politely. | She: She is spoken to politely.

Negative — I: I am not spoken to politely. | She: She is not spoken to politely.

Question — I: Am I spoken to politely? | She: Is she spoken to politely?

Present Continuous (A2)

Form: am / is / are + V-ing

Action happening now, a temporary situation, or a future arrangement.

Speak — I am speaking to my manager right now.

Do/Done — We are doing an important project this month.

Eat — She is eating lunch at the moment.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I am speaking to my manager now. | She: She is speaking to her manager now.

Negative — I: I am not speaking to my manager now. | She: She is not speaking to her manager now.

Question — I: Am I speaking to my manager now? | She: Is she speaking to her manager now?

Past Simple (A1)

Form: V-ed / V2

A finished action in the past.

Speak — I spoke to him yesterday.

Do/Done — We did the report last week.

Eat — I ate an apple this morning.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I spoke to him yesterday. | She: She spoke to him yesterday.

Negative — I: I didn't speak to him yesterday. | She: She didn't speak to him yesterday.

Question — I: Did I speak to him yesterday? | She: Did she speak to him yesterday?

Past Simple Passive (A2)

Form: was / were + V3

Focus on the action done to the subject, in the past.

Speak — The truth was spoken at the meeting.

Do/Done — The task was done on time.

Eat — The cake was eaten before dinner.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I was spoken to at the meeting. | She: She was spoken to at the meeting.

Negative — I: I was not spoken to at the meeting. | She: She was not spoken to at the meeting.

Question — I: Was I spoken to at the meeting? | She: Was she spoken to at the meeting?

Past Continuous (A2)

Form: was / were + V-ing

An action in progress in the past; also used for polite requests.

Speak — I was speaking when you called.

Do/Done — They were doing homework at 8 p.m.

Eat — She was eating when the phone rang.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I was speaking when you called. | She: She was speaking when you called.

Negative — I: I wasn't speaking when you called. | She: She wasn't speaking when you called.

Question — I: Was I speaking when you called? | She: Was she speaking when you called?

Future Simple (will) (A2)

Form: will + V

Future decisions and predictions.

Speak — I will speak to her tomorrow.

Do/Done — We will do it next week.

Eat — They will eat dinner at 8.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I will speak to her tomorrow. | She: She will speak to him tomorrow.

Negative — I: I won't speak to her tomorrow. | She: She won't speak to him tomorrow.

Question — I: Will I speak to her tomorrow? | She: Will she speak to him tomorrow?

Future Continuous (B1)

Form: will be + V-ing

An action that will be in progress at a specific time in the future.

Speak — I will be speaking at the conference at 10 a.m.

Do/Done — She will be doing the presentation at noon.

Eat — We will be eating at 8 p.m. tomorrow.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I will be speaking at 10 a.m. | She: She will be speaking at 10 a.m.

Negative — I: I won't be speaking at 10 a.m. | She: She won't be speaking at 10 a.m.

Question — I: Will I be speaking at 10 a.m.? | She: Will she be speaking at 10 a.m.?

Present Perfect (B1)

Form: have / has + V3

A past action with a result or relevance now.

Speak — I have spoken to him already.

Do/Done — She has done her homework.

Eat — I have eaten already.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I have spoken to him already. | She: She has spoken to him already.

Negative — I: I haven't spoken to him yet. | She: She hasn't spoken to him yet.

Question — I: Have I spoken to him already? | She: Has she spoken to him already?

Past Perfect (B1)

Form: had + V3

An action that happened before another action in the past; also used with if for regrets.

Speak — I had spoken to her before he arrived.

Do/Done — We had done the work before the deadline.

Eat — I had eaten before they arrived.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I had spoken to her before he arrived. | She: She had spoken to him before he arrived.

Negative — I: I hadn't spoken to her before he arrived. | She: She hadn't spoken to him before he arrived.

Question — I: Had I spoken to her before he arrived? | She: Had she spoken to him before he arrived?

Future Simple Passive (B1)

Form: will be + V3

A future action done to the subject, focus on the event and not on who does it.

Speak — The news will be spoken at the ceremony.

Do/Done — The task will be done by Friday.

Eat — Dinner will be eaten at 8.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I will be spoken to at the ceremony. | She: She will be spoken to at the ceremony.

Negative — I: I won't be spoken to at the ceremony. | She: She won't be spoken to at the ceremony.

Question — I: Will I be spoken to at the ceremony? | She: Will she be spoken to at the ceremony?

Present Perfect Continuous (B2)**Form: have / has been + V-ing**

An action that started in the past and is still continuing now; focus on duration.

Speak — I have been speaking English for two years.

Do/Done — We have been doing this project for months.

Eat — I have been eating too much lately.

Affirmative / Negative / Question (with speak):

Affirmative — I: I have been speaking English for two years. | She: She has been speaking English for two years.

Negative — I: I haven't been speaking English for very long. | She: She hasn't been speaking English for very long.

Question — I: Have I been speaking English for long? | She: Has she been speaking English for long?

Appendix B — Extended Modal Verbs Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 7. Modal Verbs](#)

CAN — ability, possibility, informal permission

I can drive.

She can speak English.

Workplace example — Can you send me the file before noon?

COULD — past ability, possibility, polite requests

I could swim when I was 5.

Could you help me?

Workplace example — Could we open the window, please?

WOULD — conditional, politeness, preferences

I would like a coffee.

I would like to discuss this topic.

Workplace example — Would you be so kind as to help me with this report?

SHOULD — recommendations, advice, opinions

You should study every day.

We should increase the safety stock.

Workplace example — You should send the invoice before the end of the month.

NEED TO — practical necessity (internal pressure)

I need to call the supplier.

We need to update the planning file.

Workplace example — We need to do this analysis before the client meeting.

HAVE TO — obligation imposed by a rule, procedure or situation (external pressure)

I had to wear a badge at work.

We have to follow customer requirements.

Workplace example — I have to complete the compliance training this week.

MUST — very strong, mandatory obligation

You must wear a helmet.

I must finish this report.

Workplace example — Every employee must comply with the updated safety regulations.

MAY — possibility, formal permission

It may rain tomorrow.

May I come in?

Workplace example — May I take a short break before the next call?

MIGHT — weaker possibility

The supplier might be late.

We might have a shortage next month.

Workplace example — We might need to postpone the deadline by a week.

Appendix C — Extended Linking Words Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 8. Linking Words](#)

Adverb placement trips up even confident speakers. This reference spells out the rules with clear examples.

#	Linking Words	Explanation	Level	Example
1	Additionally	Additional info	B2	The system is fast; additionally, it is cost-effective.
2	After	Time sequence	A1	After the meeting ended, we reviewed the notes.
3	After all	Justification / Argument	B2	We should help him; after all, he is a colleague.
4	Afterward	Time / Afterwards	B1	She finished her homework and went out afterward.
5	Afterwards	Time (variant)	B1	The team celebrated afterwards at a local restaurant.
6	Again	Repetition / Addition	A1	He failed the test, but he will try again tomorrow.

#	Linking Words	Explanation	Level	Example
7	All in all	General conclusion	B2	All in all, the project was a major success.
8	All things considered	Summarising / Evaluation	B2	All things considered, we made the best choice.
9	Along	Movement / Direction	A2	We walked along the river bank for an hour.
10	Along with	Association / Inclusion	B1	He sent the report along with the financial statements.
11	Also	Additional info	A1	She is a talented writer and also an artist.
12	Altogether	Totalling / Conclusion	B2	The structure was altogether too unstable to fix.
13	Although	Contrast / Concession	B1	Although it was late, they continued working.
14	And	Basic connector	A1	I bought a new laptop and a wireless mouse.
15	And all	Informal inclusion	B1	He dropped his phone in the water, case and all.
16	Apart from	Exception / Exclusion	B1	Apart from the low salary, the job is perfect.
17	As a consequence of	Formal result	C1	The river flooded as a consequence of the heavy rain.
18	As a result	Direct result	B2	Sales dropped; as a result, profits decreased.
19	As a result of	Cause / Effect	B2	He succeeded as a result of continuous hard work.
20	As for example	Specific illustration	B2	Some elements, as for example gold, do not rust.
21	As requested by	Authority / Source	B2	As requested by the client, we changed the design.
22	As well	Addition at the end	A2	If you are going to the store, I will come as well.
23	As well as	Inclusion / Addition	A2	The course covers coding as well as web design.
24	At the same time	Time / Contrast	B1	He was excited but at the same time terrified.
25	Because	Direct cause	A1	We cancelled the picnic because it started to snow.
26	Because of	Nominal cause	A2	The match was delayed because of the heavy fog.
27	Before that	Earlier sequence	A2	He moved to Paris; before that, he lived in Lyon.
28	But	Simple contrast	A1	She wanted to reply, but she had no internet link.

#	Linking Words	Explanation	Level	Example
29	Briefly	Concise summary	B2	Briefly, our goal is to improve customer service.
30	By and large	Generalisation	C1	By and large, the new policy was well received.
31	By the way	Change of topic	A2	I liked your essay. By the way, here is your pen.
32	By the same	Correlative comparison	B2	He acts with caution, and by the same logic, so do I.
33	By the same token	Related argument	C1	If prices rise, by the same token, wages must grow.
34	Consequent from	Derived result	C2	The inflation consequent from the war ruined the market.
35	Consequent to	Formal consequence	C2	Changes were made consequent to the investigation.
36	Consequently	Academic result	B2	Taxes went up; consequently, spending fell down.
37	Continuously	Uninterrupted frequency	B2	The machine has been running continuously for days.
38	Despite	Contrast / Concession	B2	Despite the traffic, we arrived exactly on time.
39	Despite this	Contextual contrast	B2	The plan was risky; despite this, they approved it.
40	Equally	Equality / Addition	B1	The two options are equally attractive to users.
41	Even so	Strong concession	B2	It was dangerous; even so, he decided to try it.
42	Even though	Emphatic contrast	B1	Even though she studied, she failed the driver's test.
43	Except for	Exclusion	A2	The room was empty except for an old wooden table.
44	Finally	Conclusion / Sequence	A2	Finally, click 'Submit' to complete your order.
45	First / Firstly	Starting a list	A2	First, we need to gather all relevant data points.
46	First of all	Initial emphasis	A2	First of all, thank you all for joining us today.
47	First, Second...	Structural listing	A2	First, analyze the text; second, write a summary.
48	Following this	Time succession	B1	Following this, the software will restart automatically.

#	Linking Words	Explanation	Level	Example
49	For	Cause (literary/formal)	C1	We must rest, for the journey ahead is very long.
50	For example	Standard exemplification	A2	Citrus fruits, for example oranges, contain vitamin C.
51	For instance	Formal exemplification	B1	You can use alternative energy, for instance, solar panels.
52	For one thing	Initial argument	B2	I won't go; for one thing, I don't have enough cash.
53	For the most part	Generalisation / Majority	B2	The students, for the most part, understood the lesson.
54	For that reason	Logical conclusion	B2	He lied; for that reason, I cannot trust him anymore.
55	Further	Advanced addition	B2	We need further evidence before making a final decision.
56	Furthermore	Academic addition	B2	The text is long; furthermore, it lacks arguments.
57	Hence	Conclusion / Hence	C1	The roads were icy, hence the high amount of accidents.
58	However	Standard contrast	B1	She ran fast; however, she missed the morning train.
59	In addition	Formal addition	B2	In addition to French, she speaks fluent Spanish.
60	Indeed	Emphasis / Confirmation	B2	The results were indeed better than we anticipated.
61	In contrast	Isolated contrast	C1	He is very shy; in contrast, his brother is outgoing.
62	In general	Broad generalisation	B1	In general, older adults prefer quiet neighborhoods.
63	In summary	Ending an essay	B2	In summary, the data supports our main hypothesis.
64	In the beginning	Initial time frame	A2	In the beginning, learning to code felt impossible.
65	In the case of	Contextualisation	B1	In the case of an emergency, please press this button.
66	In the end	Late final result	B1	We argued for hours, but in the end, we agreed.
67	In the first place	Basic argument	B2	You should not have gone there in the first place.
68	In the long run	Future perspective	B2	Saving money now will benefit you in the long run.

#	Linking Words	Explanation	Level	Example
69	In the same way	Similarity / Parallel	B2	Regular exercise benefits the heart in the same way.
70	In this manner	Manner / Procedure	C1	Execute the steps in this manner to ensure safety.
71	Is due to	Causal attribution	B2	The project delay is due to an unexpected budget cut.
72	Is the consequence of	Effect-cause relationship	C1	Global warming is the consequence of human actions.
73	Just as	Exact time correlation	B1	The alarm went off just as I entered the kitchen.
74	Just as... so too	Advanced analogy	C1	Just as plants need sun, so too humans need love.
75	Last	Final element	A2	Last, check the system parameters for any errors.
76	Lastly	Final item in a list	B1	Lastly, I would like to thank our volunteer team.
77	Leads to	Active causality	B1	A lack of sleep often leads to poor concentration.
78	Like	Comparison / Example	A1	He wanted to buy a sports car like yours.
79	Likewise	Repeated action	B2	The first test failed; likewise, the second test crashed.
80	Meanwhile	Simultaneous actions	B1	Cook the pasta; meanwhile, prepare the tomato sauce.
81	Moreover	Academic addition	B2	The house is small; moreover, it is far from town.
82	Nevertheless	Formal concession	C1	The task was hard; nevertheless, they finished it.
83	Nor	Correlative negation	B2	She does not like coffee, nor does she drink tea.
84	Not only... but also	Emphatic double structure	B1	He is not only intelligent but also very humble.
85	On balance	Balanced conclusion	C1	On balance, the report presents a fair perspective.
86	On the contrary	Direct contradiction	B2	He is not lazy; on the contrary, he works non-stop.
87	On the other hand	Alternative / Contrast	B2	Laptops are powerful; on the other hand, they are heavy.
88	Or	Simple alternative	A1	You can choose to pay by credit card or cash.

#	Linking Words	Explanation	Level	Example
89	Owing to	Formal cause	B2	The flight was delayed owing to technical issues.
90	Result from	Origin of an effect	B2	Many health benefits result from a balanced diet.
91	Similarly	Structural similarity	B2	The law applies to firms and, similarly, to individuals.
92	Since	Chronological cause / Reason	A2	Since you are here, you can help us clean up.
93	So	Simple consequence	A1	It was getting late, so we decided to leave.
94	Still	Contrast / Continuity	A2	The map was old, but we still found the cabin safely.
95	Summary	Concluding noun	B1	Write a brief summary of the final chapter.
96	The next step	Procedural sequence	B1	The next step is to test the internal algorithm.
97	Then	Logical succession / Time	A1	First, heat the oil, then add the chopped onions.
98	Therefore	Demonstrative conclusion	B2	He missed the bus; therefore, he was late for work.
99	Thus	Formal manner / Consequence	C1	He lowered prices, thus attracting more customers.
100	To begin with	Introduction / Basic argument	B1	To begin with, we lack the necessary budget.
101	To conclude	Closing an essay	B2	To conclude, artificial intelligence is transforming medical fields.
102	To summarize	Text synthesis	B2	To summarize, the meeting was a complete waste of time.
103	Too	Addition (at the end)	A1	I am fond of jazz music, and I like classical rock too.
104	What is more	Emphatic addition	C1	The car is affordable; what is more, it saves fuel.
105	Whereas	Direct simultaneous contrast	C1	He likes hot weather, whereas his wife prefers snow.
106	Yet	Unexpected contrast	B2	It was an easy riddle, yet nobody solved it on time.

Appendix D — Extended Comparison Adjectives Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 5. Comparison Adjectives](#)

Some adjectives are not used in comparison, as they are already superlative. For instance: *Verbs, nouns, adjectives and adverbs often share a root — here is the complete word-family list, grouped by theme.*

#	Absolute Adjective	Correct Example	Common Mistake to Avoid
1	Unique	This AI automation framework is truly unique .	<i>This tool is more unique. ✗</i>
2	Perfect	The graphic designer created a nearly perfect layout grid.	<i>This design is the most perfect. ✗</i>
3	Final	The manager gave the final decision on the budget.	<i>This is the most final draft. ✗</i>
4	Complete	The formalization of the data is now complete .	<i>The report is more complete today. ✗</i>
5	Dead	The server stack is dead after the system crash.	<i>The backup server is more dead. ✗</i>
6	Universal	This SAP solution has a universal application.	<i>This module is the most universal. ✗</i>
7	Infinite	The cloud platform provides infinite storage options.	<i>This database size is more infinite. ✗</i>
8	Empty	The data folder on the network is empty .	<i>This backup disk is more empty. ✗</i>
9	Full	The storage drive for company resources is completely/ half full .	<i>The server rack is the most full. ✗</i>
10	Correct	The financial data in the report is partially correct .	<i>Your calculations are more correct. ✗</i>
11	Incorrect	The system path configuration is wholly incorrect .	<i>This error code is more incorrect. ✗</i>
12	Impossible	It is impossible to recover data without backups.	<i>This SAP migration is more impossible. ✗</i>
13	Absolute	The board of directors has absolute control.	<i>We need a more absolute proof. ✗</i>
14	Fatal	The central processor encountered a fatal error.	<i>This system bug was more fatal. ✗</i>
15	Supreme	The global council holds the supreme authority.	<i>This court decision is the most supreme. ✗</i>
16	Ultimate	Achieving a beautiful life is the ultimate goal.	<i>This is our more ultimate solution. ✗</i>
17	Eternal	Nature represents the eternal beauty of the world.	<i>This principle is more eternal. ✗</i>
18	Ideal	This clean environment is ideal for a healthy life.	<i>We found a more ideal location. ✗</i>
19	Matchless	The designer has a matchless artistic style.	<i>His talent is the most matchless. ✗</i>

#	Absolute Adjective	Correct Example	Common Mistake to Avoid
20	Total	The system failure caused a total blackout.	<i>The quarterly loss was more total. ✗</i>
21	Unanimous	The board made a unanimous vote on the budget.	<i>The decision was more unanimous. ✗</i>
22	Flawless	The AI tool generated a flawless block of code.	<i>Her presentation was more flawless. ✗</i>
23	Blind	Automated systems shouldn't have blind trust.	<i>This algorithm is more blind. ✗</i>
24	Pregnant	She is heavily pregnant and will take maternity leave.	<i>She is more pregnant than her. ✗</i>

Below there is a **comprehensive** list of comparative adjectives:

Every irregular verb from this course, together with its past forms and pronunciation, is collected here for quick lookup.

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Angry	Angrier than you (2 pers/objects)	The Angriest
Bad	Worse than you	The Worst in the world
Beautiful	More Beautiful than you (2 pers/objects)	The Most Beautiful + in the family/group.
Big	Bigger	Biggest
Bitter	Bitterer	Bitterest
Black	Blacker	Blackest
Bland	Blander	Blandest
Bloody	Bloodier	Bloodiest
Blue	Bluer	Bluest
Bold	Bolder	Boldest
Bossy	Bossier	Bossiest
Brave	Braver	Bravest
Brief	Briefer	Briefest
Bright	Brighter	Brightest
Broad	Broader	Broadest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Busy	Busier	Busiest
Calm	Calmer	Caldest /ka:m/
Cheap	Cheaper	Cheapest
Chewy	Chewier	Chewiest
Chubby	Chubbier	Chubbiest
Classy	Classier	Classiest
Clean	Cleaner	Cleanest
Clear	Clearer	Clearest
Clever	Cleverer/More Clever	Cleverest/Most Clever
Close	Closer	Closest
Cloudy	Cloudier	Cloudiest
Clumsy	Clumsier	Clumsiest
Coarse	Coarser	Coarsest
Cold	Colder	Coldest
Cool	Cooler	Coolest
Crazy	Crazier	Craziest
Creamy	Creamier	Creamiest
Creepy	Creepier	Creepiest
Crispy	Crispier	Crispiest
Cruel	More Cruel	Most Cruel
Crunchy	Crunchier	Crunchiest
Curly	Curly	Curliest
Curvy	Curvier	Curviest
Cute	Cuter	Cutest
Damp	Damper	Dampest
Dark	Darker	Darkest
Deadly	Deadlier	Deadliest
Dear	Dearer	Dearest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-Er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Deep	Deeper	Deepest
Dense	Denser	Densest
Difficult	More Difficult	Most Difficult
Dirty	Dirtier	Dirtiest
Dry	Drier	Driest
Dull	Duller	Dullest
Dumb	Dumber	Dumbest
Dusty	Dustier	Dustiest
Early	Earlier	Earliest
Easy	Easier	Easiest
Empty	Emptier	Emptiest
Faint	Fainter	Faintest
Fair	Fairer	Fairest
Famous	More Famous	Most Famous
Fancy	Fancier	Fanciest
Fast	Faster	Fastest
Fat	Fatter	Fattest
Few	Fewer	Fewest
Fierce	Fiercer	Fiercest
Filthy	Filthier	Filthiest
Fine	Finer	Finest
Firm	Firmer	Firmest
Fit	Fitter	Fittest
Flaky	Flakier	Flakiest
Flat	Flatter	Flattest
Foolish	More Foolish	Most Foolish
Fresh	Fresher	Freshest
Friendly	Friendlier	Friendliest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-Er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Full	Fuller	Fullest
Funny	Funnier	Funniest
Gentle	Gentler	Gentlest
Gloomy	Gloomier	Gloomiest
Good	Better	Best
Grand	Grander	Grandest
Grave	Graver	Gravest
Greasy	Greasier	Greasiest
Great	Greater	Greatest
Greedy	Greedier	Greediest
Green	Greener	Greenest
Gross	Grosser	Grossest
Guilty	Guilter	Guiltiest
Hairy	Hairier	Hairiest
Handy	Handier	Handiest
Happy	Happier	Happiest
Hard	Harder	Hardest
Harsh	Harsher	Harshest
Healthy	Healthier	Healthiest
Heavy	Heavier	Heaviest
High	Higher	Highest
Hip	Hipper	Hippest
Hot	Hotter	Hottest
Humble	Humbler	Humblest
Hungry	Hungrier	Hungriest
Icy	Icier	Iciest
Itchy	Itchier	Itchiest
Juicy	Juicier	Juiciest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-Er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Kind	Kinder	Kindest
Large	Larger	Largest
Late	Later	Latest
Lazy	Lazier	Laziest
Light	Lighter	Lightest
Likely	Likelier	Likeliest
Little	Less	Least
Little	Littler	Littlest
Little	Littler	Littlest
Lively	Livelier	Liveliest
Lonely	Lonlier	Loneliest
Long	Longer	Longest
Loud	Louder	Loudest
Lovely	Lovelier	Loveliest
Low	Lower	Lowest
Mad	Madder	Maddest
Many	More	Most
Mean	Meaner	Meanest
Messy	Messier	Messiest
Mild	Milder	Mildest
Moist	Moister	Moistest
Narrow	Narrower	Narrowest
Nasty	Nastier	Nastiest
Naughty	Naughtier	Naughtiest
Near	Nearer	Nearest
Neat	Neater	Neatest
Needy	Needier	Neediest
New	Newer	Newest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-Er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Nice	Nicer	Nicest
Noisy	Noisier	Noisiest
Odd	Odder	Oddest
Oily	Oilier	Oiliest
Old	Older/Elder	Oldest/Eldest
Plain	Plainer	Plainest
Polite	Politer	Politest
Poor	Poorer	Poorest
Popular	More Popular	Most Popular
Pretty	Prettier	Prettiest
Proud	Prouder	Proudest
Pure	Purer	Purest
Quick	Quicker	Quickest
Quiet	Quieter	Quietest
Rare	Rarer	Rarest
Raw	Rawer	Rawest
Renowned	More Renowned	Most Renowned
Rich	Richer	Richest
Ripe	Riper	Ripest
Risky	Riskier	Riskiest
Roomy	Roomier	Roomiest
Rough	Rougher	Roughest
Rude	Ruder	Rudest
Rusty	Rustier	Rustiest
Sad	Sadder	Saddest
Safe	Safer	Safest
Salty	Saltier	Saltiest
Sane	Saner	Sanest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Scary	Scarier	Scariest
Shallow	Shallower	Shallowest
Sharp	Sharper	Sharpest
Shiny	Shinier	Shiniest
Short	Shorter	Shortest
Shy	Shyer	Shyest
Silly	Sillier	Silliest
Simple	Simpler	Simplest
Sincere	Sincerer	Sincerest
Skinny	Skinnier	Skinniest
Sleepy	Sleepier	Sleepiest
Slim	Slimmer	Slimmest
Slimy	Slimier	Slimiest
Slow	Slower	Slowest
Small	Smaller	Smallest
Smart	Smarter	Smartest
Smelly	Smellier	Smelliest
Smoky	Smokier	Smokiest
Smooth	Smoother	Smoothest
Soft	Softer	Softest
Soon	Sooner	Soonest
Sore	Sorer	Sorest
Sorry	Sorrier	Sorriest
Sour	Sourer	Sourest
Spicy	Spicier	Spiciest
Steep	Steeper	Steepest
Stingy	Stingier	Stingiest
Strange	Stranger	Strangest

Adjective	Comparative (more) (2 pers/objects): Adj-er + than (short adjective) More Adj + than (long adjective)	Superlative (the most): (3+ pers/objects) The Adj-est -> (short adjective) The Most -> (long adjective)
Strict	Stricter	Strictest
Strong	Stronger	Strongest
Sunny	Sunnier	Sunniest
Sweaty	Sweatier	Sweatiest
Sweet	Sweeter	Sweetest
Tall	Taller	Tallest
Tan	Tanner	Tannest
Tasty	Tastier	Tastiest
Thick	Thicker	Thickest
Thin	Thinner	Thinnest
Thirsty	Thirstier	Thirstiest
Tiny	Tinier	Tiniest
Tough	Tougher	Toughest
TRUE	Truer	Truest
Ugly	Uglier	Ugliest
Warm	Warmer	Warmest
Weak	Weaker	Weakest
Wealthy	Wealthier	Wealthiest
Weird	Weirder	Weirdest
Wet	Wetter	Wettest
Wide	Wider	Widest
Wild	Wilder	Wildest
Windy	Windier	Windiest
Wise	Wiser	Wisest
Worldly	Worldlier	Worldliest
Worthy	Worthier	Worthiest
Young	Younger	Youngest

Appendix E — Extended Adverbs Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 4. Adverbs](#)

Adverb Placement Rules — Full Reference

Regular verbs are simpler, but seeing them all together still helps. Here is the full set with pronunciation guides.

Rule Type	Position	Short Rule	Correct Example
1. Transitive Verbs (The Magnet Rule)	Before the verb OR at the end of the sentence	Never separate a transitive verb from its direct object with an adverb.	They successfully integrated the components. OR They integrated the components successfully.
Quick test for transitive verbs: ask What? or Whom? right after the verb. If you can ask What? immediately after a verb, that verb is transitive. Example: I built... → the mind wants details: Built what? → ...a house. The verb build is transitive.			
2. Intransitive Verbs	Immediately after the verb (sometimes before, depending on the verb)	Since there is no direct object, the adverb attaches directly after the action.	The system functioned perfectly. The system perfectly functioned. ✗ The system slowly functioned.
Quick test for intransitive verbs: the question What? or Whom? does NOT work. If you try to ask What? right after an intransitive verb, the question makes no sense: The server crashed — you cannot ask crashed what?; the action simply happens, and the meaning is already complete. The sun shines — it does not shine someone, it just performs the action.			
3. With the verb To Be	After the verb To Be	Unlike action verbs, to be attracts frequency adverbs after it.	The database is usually stable.
4. Degree / Intensity Adverbs (EXCEPTION)	ONLY before the verb	Words like almost, barely, hardly, nearly, just, only are never allowed at the end of the sentence.	We nearly missed the deadline. Wrong: We missed the deadline nearly. ✗
5. Frequency Adverbs (EXCEPTION)	Before action verbs	Words like always, often, rarely, seldom, never always stand before the main action.	They always update the source code. Wrong: They update the source code always. ✗
6. Compound Tenses (with auxiliary verbs)	In the middle (between the auxiliary and the main verb)	With verbs like have, will, is, can, the adverb goes between the auxiliary and the main verb.	The team has successfully deployed the hotfix.
7. Focusing Adverbs	Directly before the word being modified	Adverbs like specifically, mainly, mostly, simply must sit right next to the term they highlight.	This patch specifically addresses memory leaks.
8. Opinion / Sentence Adverbs	At the start of the sentence (followed by a comma)	Words like fortunately, luckily, surprisingly, honestly modify the whole	Fortunately, the server recovered automatically.

Rule Type	Position	Short Rule	Correct Example
		idea and open the sentence.	

Verb → Noun → Adjective → Adverb word families, grouped by theme and sorted alphabetically by category.

Word Families by Category — Full Reference

Prepositions can be tricky. This table walks through common usage patterns, verbs and typical scenarios for each one.

Category	Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
Attention / Caution	We CAUTION users.	CAUTION is needed.	Be CAUTIOUS .	Act CAUTIOUSLY .
	We WAIT calmly.	PATIENCE helps.	Be PATIENT .	Wait PATIENTLY .
Business / Compliance	We COMPLY with regulations.	COMPLIANCE is required.	The process is COMPLIANT .	Work COMPLIANTLY .
	We FORMALIZED the agreement.	FORMALITY is expected.	The meeting is FORMAL .	Dress FORMALLY .
	Teams INNOVATE constantly.	INNOVATION drives growth.	The solution is INNOVATIVE .	Think INNOVATIVELY .
	Companies COMPETE globally.	COMPETITION increased.	The market is COMPETITIVE .	Price COMPETITIVELY .
Certainty / Opinion	We DECIDED quickly.	A DECISION was made.	She is DECISIVE .	She acted DECISIVELY .
	The problem APPEARED .	Its APPEARANCE changed.	The cause was APPARENT .	APPARENTLY , it failed.
	Results SHOWED progress.	The OBVIOUSNESS surprised us.	The answer is OBVIOUS .	OBVIOUSLY , it works.
	Facts ACTUALIZE plans.	Check the ACTUALS .	The ACTUAL cost increased.	ACTUALLY , you're right.
	We EXPECT delays.	The PROBABILITY is high.	A delay is PROBABLE .	PROBABLY , it will rain.
	We PREDICT growth.	There is a POSSIBILITY .	It is POSSIBLE .	POSSIBLY , tomorrow.
	We DEFINE priorities.	We need DEFINITIONS .	The result is DEFINITE .	DEFINITELY , yes.
Clarity / Precision	Please CLARIFY this.	We need CLARITY .	The message is CLEAR .	Speak CLEARLY .
	We MEASURE everything.	PRECISION matters.	The value is PRECISE .	Measure PRECISELY .
	Please SPECIFY details.	Read the SPECIFICATION .	We need SPECIFIC data.	SPECIFICALLY this item.
	We VERIFY results.	ACCURACY is important.	The data is ACCURATE .	Work ACCURATELY .
Communication / Teamwork	We DIRECT operations.	The DIRECTION is clear.	The message is DIRECT .	Speak DIRECTLY .
	Teams COLLABORATE daily.	COLLABORATION improved.	The team is COLLABORATIVE .	Work COLLABORATIVELY .

Category	Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
	We COMMUNICATE clearly.	COMMUNICATION is essential.	The manager is COMMUNICATIVE .	Communicate COMMUNICATIVELY .
	We RESPOND quickly.	The RESPONSE was fast.	The service is RESPONSIVE .	React RESPONSIVELY .
	We SPEAK openly.	HONESTY matters.	The feedback is HONEST .	Answer HONESTLY .
	We RESPOND professionally.	RESPONSIBILITY increased.	The employee is RESPONSIBLE .	Act RESPONSIBLY .
Decision / Determination	We DECIDE quickly.	The DECISION helped.	She is DECISIVE .	Act DECISIVELY .
	They BRAVE risks.	Their braver impressed.	The team is BRAVE .	Move BRAVELY .
	We RESOLVE issues.	The RESOLUTION worked.	The manager is RESOLUTE .	Work RESOLUTELY .
Frequency / Time	We REPEAT tasks.	REGULARITY matters.	The process is REGULAR .	Check REGULARLY .
	I FREQUENT this site.	FREQUENCY is high.	It is FREQUENT .	It happens FREQUENTLY .
	Work CONTINUES .	The CONTINUATION was approved.	The process is CONTINUOUS .	It runs CONTINUOUSLY .
	We FINALIZE today.	The FINALIZATION ended.	The report is FINAL .	FINALLY , we're done.
	The project ORIGINATED here.	The ORIGIN is clear.	The plan is ORIGINAL .	ORIGINALLY , we agreed.
	Events OCCUR together.	The SIMULTANEITY is evident.	The actions are SIMULTANEOUS .	Both started SIMULTANEOUSLY .
	The change REMAINS .	PERMANENCE is valuable.	The solution is PERMANENT .	It stays PERMANENTLY .
	The team consists of experts.	The CONSISTENCY improved.	The quality is CONSISTENT .	Work CONSISTENTLY .
Importance / Intensity	We FOCUS on quality.	The PARTICULARITY is notable.	This case is PARTICULAR .	PARTICULARLY important.
	Sales SIGNIFIED progress.	The SIGNIFICANCE is clear.	The impact is SIGNIFICANT .	Sales rose SIGNIFICANTLY .
	Pressure INTENSIFIED .	The INTENSITY increased.	The workload is INTENSE .	The market changed INTENSELY .
	We TOTAL the costs.	The TOTAL reached 100.	The amount is TOTAL .	TOTALLY agreed.
	The merger COMPLETED .	The COMPLETENESS helped.	The report is WHOLE .	WHOLLY owned.
	We URGED action.	The URGENCY was obvious.	The issue is URGENT .	Reply URGENTLY .
Performance / Efficiency	We IMPROVE processes.	EFFICIENCY increased.	The workflow is EFFICIENT .	Work EFFICIENTLY .
	We SUCCEDED .	The SUCCESS was obvious.	The project was SUCCESSFUL .	It ended SUCCESSFULLY .

Category	Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
	The team PRODUCES results.	PRODUCTIVITY grew.	The employee is PRODUCTIVE .	Work PRODUCTIVELY .
	We RELY on data.	RELIABILITY matters.	The system is RELIABLE .	The system works RELIABLY .
	We ADAPT resources.	ADEQUACY is important.	The budget is ADEQUATE .	It was done ADEQUATELY .
	The stock SUFFICES .	SUFFICIENCY matters.	The stock is SUFFICIENT .	The stock is SUFFICIENTLY high.
	We ENABLE teams.	CAPABILITY increased.	The team is CAPABLE .	The team worked CAPABLY .
Possibility	We CAN proceed.	POSSIBILITY exists.	It is POSSIBLE .	POSSIBLY tomorrow.
	We DEVELOP ideas.	POTENTIAL is high.	The opportunity is POTENTIAL .	POTENTIALLY beneficial.
	We PREDICT demand.	PREDICTION helps planning.	The result is PREDICTABLE .	PREDICTABLY , sales rose.
	We REQUIRE changes.	NECESSITY drove action.	The update is NECESSARY .	NECESSARILY so.
Safety / Protection	We SAVE lives.	SAFETY comes first.	The site is SAFE .	Drive SAFELY .
	We PROTECT assets.	PROTECTION is essential.	The equipment is PROTECTIVE .	Store data PROTECTIVELY .
	The system STABILIZED .	STABILITY matters.	The process is STABLE .	Operate STABLY .
	We LEGALIZED the process.	LEGALITY was confirmed.	The contract is LEGAL .	Act LEGALLY .
Simplicity	We SIMPLIFY processes.	SIMPLICITY matters.	The process is SIMPLE .	Explain SIMPLY .
	We PART solutions.	The PART was delayed.	The result is PARTIAL .	Only PARTIALLY completed.

Appendix F — Extended Irregular Verbs Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 13. Irregular and regular Verbs](#)

For a deeper dive into prepositions in context, here is an extended set of scenarios and example sentences.

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar: Perfect /Passive/Adjectives/v3	Phonetics
Bring	/brɪŋ/	Brought	/brɔ:t/	Brought	/brɔ:t/
Broadcast	/'brɔ:dkæst	Broadcast	/'brɔ:dkæst/	Broadcast	/'brɔ:dkæst/
Buy	/baɪ/	Bought	/bɔ:t/	Bought	/bɔ:t/
Can	/kæn/	Could	/kʊd/	Could	/kʊd/
Cast	/kæst/	Cast	/kæst/	Cast	/kæst/
Catch	/kætʃ/	Caught	/kɔ:t/	Caught	/kɔ:t/
Choose	/tʃu:z/	Chose	/tʃoʊz/	Chosen	/'tʃoʊzn/
Cling	/klɪŋ/	Clung	/klʌŋ/	Clung	/klʌŋ/
Come	/kʌm/	Came	/keɪm/	Come	/kʌm/

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar: Perfect /Passive/Adjectives/v3	Phonetics
Cost	/kɒst/	Cost	/kɒst/	Cost	/kɒst/
Creep	/kri:p/	Crept	/krept/	Crept	/krept/
Cut	/kʌt/	Cut	/kʌt/	Cut	/kʌt/
Deal	/di:l/	Dealt	/delt/	Dealt	/delt/
Dig	/dɪg/	Dug	/dʌg/	Dug	/dʌg/
Do	/du:/	Did	/dɪd/	Done	/dʌn/
Draw	/drɔ:/	Drew	/dru:/	Drawn	/drɔ:n/
Dream	/dri:m/	Dreamt	/dremt/	Dreamt	/dremt/
Drink	/drɪŋk/	Drank	/dræŋk/	Drunk	/drʌŋk/
Drive	/draɪv/	Drove	/droʊv/	Driven	/ˈdri:vən/
Dwell	/dwel/	Dwelt	/dwelt/	Dwelt	/dwelt/
Eat	/i:t/	Ate	/eɪt/	Eaten	/ˈi:tn/
Fall	/fɔ:l/	Fell	/fel/	Fallen	/ˈfɔ:lən/
Feel	/fi:l/	Felt	/felt/	Felt	/felt/
Fight	/faɪt/	Fought	/fɔ:t/	Fought	/fɔ:t/
Find	/faɪnd/	Found	/faʊnd/	Found	/faʊnd/
Fly	/flaɪ/	Flew	/flu:/	Flown	/floʊn/
Forget	/fərˈget/	Forgot	/fərˈɡɒt/	Forgotten	/fərˈɡɒtn/
Forgive	/fərˈɡɪv/	Forgave	/fərˈgeɪv/	Forgiven	/fərˈɡɪvn/
Freeze	/fri:z/	Froze	/frouz/	Frozen	/ˈfrouzn/
Get	/get/	Got	/ɡɒt/	Got	/ɡɒt/
Give	/ɡɪv/	Gave	/geɪv/	Given	/ˈɡɪvn/
Go	/ɡoʊ/	Went	/went/	Gone	/ɡɒn/
Grow	/ɡroʊ/	Grew	/ɡru:/	Grown	/ɡroʊn/
Hang	/hæŋ/	Hung	/hʌŋ/	Hung	/hʌŋ/
Have	/hæv/	Had	/hæd/	Had	/hæd/
Hear	/hɪər/	Heard	/hɜ:rd/	Heard	/hɜ:rd/
Hide	/haɪd/	Hid	/hɪd/	Hidden	/ˈhɪdn/
Hit	/hɪt/	Hit	/hɪt/	Hit	/hɪt/
Hold	/hoʊld/	Held	/held/	Held	/held/

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar: Perfect /Passive/Adjectives/v3	Phonetics
Hurt	/hɜ:rt/	Hurt	/hɜ:rt/	Hurt	/hɜ:rt/
Keep	/ki:p/	Kept	/kept/	Kept	/kept/
Kneel	/ni:l/	Knelt	/nelt/	Knelt	/nelt/
Know	/nou/	Knew	/nu:/	Known	/noun/
Learn	/lɜ:rn/	Learnt	/lɜ:rn/	Learnt	/lɜ:rn/
Leave	/li:v/	Left	/left/	Left	/left/
Lend	/lend/	Lent	/lent/	Lent	/lent/
Let	/let/	Let	/let/	Let	/let/
Lie	/laɪ/	Lay	/leɪ/	Lain	/leɪn/
Lose	/lu:z/	Lost	/lɒst/	Lost	/lɒst/
Make	/meɪk/	Made	/meɪd/	Made	/meɪd/
Mean	/mi:n/	Meant	/ment/	Meant	/ment/
Meet	/mi:t/	Met	/met/	Met	/met/
Pay	/peɪ/	Paid	/peɪd/	Paid	/peɪd/
Put	/pʊt/	Put	/pʊt/	Put	/pʊt/
Read	/ri:d/	Read	/red/	Read	/red/
Ride	/raɪd/	Rode	/rouɪd/	Ridden	/ˈrɪdn/
Rise	/raɪz/	Rose	/rouz/	Risen	/ˈrɪzn/
Run	/rʌn/	Ran	/ræn/	Run	/rʌn/
Say	/seɪ/	Said	/sed/	Said	/sed/
See	/si:/	Saw	/sɔ:/	Seen	/si:n/
Seek	/si:k/	Sought	/sɔ:t/	Sought	/sɔ:t/
Sell	/sel/	Sold	/sould/	Sold	/sould/
Send	/send/	Sent	/sent/	Sent	/sent/
Set	/set/	Set	/set/	Set	/set/
Shake	/ʃeɪk/	Shook	/ʃʊk/	Shaken	/ˈʃeɪkən/
Shine	/ʃaɪn/	Shone	/ʃɒn/	Shone	/ʃɒn/
Shoot	/ʃu:t/	Shot	/ʃɒt/	Shot	/ʃɒt/
Shrink	/ʃrɪŋk/	Shrank	/ʃræŋk/	Shrunk	/ʃrʌŋk/
Shut	/ʃʌt/	Shut	/ʃʌt/	Shut	/ʃʌt/

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar: Perfect /Passive/Adjectives/v3	Phonetics
Sing	/sɪŋ/	Sang	/sæŋ/	Sung	/sʌŋ/
Sink	/sɪŋk/	Sank	/sæŋk/	Sunk	/sʌŋk/
Sit	/sɪt/	Sat	/sæt/	Sat	/sæt/
Slay	/sleɪ/	Slew	/slu:/	Slain	/sleɪn/
Sleep	/sli:p/	Slept	/slept/	Slept	/slept/
Slide	/slaɪd/	Slid	/slɪd/	Slid	/slɪd/
Sling	/sɪŋ/	Slung	/sɪŋ/	Slung	/sɪŋ/
Slink	/sɪŋk/	Slunk	/sɪŋk/	Slunk	/sɪŋk/
Slit	/slɪt/	Slit	/slɪt/	Slit	/slɪt/
Smell	/smel/	Smelt	/smelt/	Smelt	/smelt/
Smite	/smaɪt/	Smote	/smoʊt/	Smitten	/ˈsmɪtn/
Speak	/spi:k/	Spoke	/spoʊk/	Spoken	/ˈspoʊkən/
Spend	/spend/	Spent	/spent/	Spent	/spent/
Spill	/spɪl/	Spilt	/spɪlt/	Spilt	/spɪlt/
Spin	/spɪn/	Spun	/spʌn/	Spun	/spʌn/
Split	/splɪt/	Split	/splɪt/	Split	/splɪt/
Spoil	/spoɪl/	Spoilt	/spoɪlt/	Spoilt	/spoɪlt/
Spread	/spred/	Spread	/spred/	Spread	/spred/
Spring	/sprɪŋ/	Sprang	/spræŋ/	Sprung	/sprʌŋ/
Stand	/stænd/	Stood	/stʊd/	Stood	/stʊd/
Steal	/sti:l/	Stole	/stoʊl/	Stolen	/ˈstoʊlən/
Stick	/stɪk/	Stuck	/stʌk/	Stuck	/stʌk/
Sting	/stɪŋ/	Stung	/stʌŋ/	Stung	/stʌŋ/
Stink	/stɪŋk/	Stank	/stæŋk/	Stunk	/stʌŋk/
Strike	/straɪk/	Struck	/strʌk/	Struck	/strʌk/
Strive	/straɪv/	Strove	/stroʊv/	Striven	/ˈstrɪvn/
Swear	/swer/	Swore	/swɔ:r/	Sworn	/swɔ:rn/
Sweep	/swi:p/	Swept	/swept/	Swept	/swept/
Swim	/swɪm/	Swam	/swæm/	Swum	/swʌm/
Take	/teɪk/	Took	/tʊk/	Taken	/ˈteɪkən/

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar: Perfect /Passive/Adjectives/v3	Phonetics
Teach	/ti:tʃ/	Taught	/tɔ:t/	Taught	/tɔ:t/
Tear	/ter/	Tore	/tɔ:r/	Torn	/tɔ:rn/
Tell	/tel/	Told	/tould/	Told	/tould/
Think	/θɪŋk/	Thought	/θɔ:t/	Thought	/θɔ:t/
Throw	/θrou/	Threw	/θru:/	Thrown	/θroun/
Understand	/ˌʌndər'stænd/	Understood	/ˌʌndər'stʊd/	Understood	/ˌʌndər'stʊd/
Wake	/weɪk/	Woke	/wouk/	Woken	/ˈwoukən/
Wear	/wer/	Wore	/wɔ:r/	Worn	/wɔ:rn/
Win	/wɪn/	Won	/wʌn/	Won	/wʌn/
Wind	/waɪnd/	Wound	/waʊnd/	Wound	/waʊnd/
Withdraw	/wɪð'drɔ:/	Withdrew	/wɪð'dru:/	Withdrawn	/wɪð'drɔ:n/

Extended regular verbs:

Talking about ownership? Here is the complete set of possessive adjectives and pronouns, subject by subject.

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar Perfect /Passive/Adjectives v3	Phonetics
Accept	/ək'sept/	Accepted	/ək'septɪd/	Accepted	/ək'septɪd/
Act	/ækt/	Acted	/ˈæktɪd/	Acted	/ˈæktɪd/
Admire	/əd'maɪər/	Admired	/əd'maɪərd/	Admired	/əd'maɪərd/
Agree	/ə'gri:/	Agreed	/ə'gri:d/	Agreed	/ə'gri:d/
Answer	/ˈænsər/	Answered	/ˈænsərd/	Answered	/ˈænsərd/
Arrive	/ə'raɪv/	Arrived	/ə'raɪvd/	Arrived	/ə'raɪvd/
Bake	/beɪk/	Baked	/beɪkt/	Baked	/beɪkt/
Behave	/bɪ'heɪv/	Behaved	/bɪ'heɪvd/	Behaved	/bɪ'heɪvd/
Believe	/bɪ'li:v/	Believed	/bɪ'li:vd/	Believed	/bɪ'li:vd/
Borrow	/ˈbɒrou/	Borrowed	/ˈbɒroud/	Borrowed	/ˈbɒroud/
Call	/kɔ:l/	Called	/kɔ:ld/	Called	/kɔ:ld/
Celebrate	/ˈselɪbreɪt/	Celebrated	/ˈselɪbreɪtɪd/	Celebrated	/ˈselɪbreɪtɪd/
Clean	/kli:n/	Cleaned	/kli:nd/	Cleaned	/kli:nd/
Climb	/klaɪm/	Climbed	/klaɪmd/	Climbed	/klaɪmd/

Present v1	Phonetics	Past Simple v2	Phonetics	Grammar Perfect /Passive/Adjectives v3	Phonetics
Close	/klaʊz/	Closed	/klaʊzd/	Closed	/klaʊzd/
Cook	/kʊk/	Cooked	/kʊkt/	Cooked	/kʊkt/
Dance	/dæns/	Danced	/dænst/	Danced	/dænst/
Decide	/dɪ'saɪd/	Decided	/dɪ'saɪdɪd/	Decided	/dɪ'saɪdɪd/
Deliver	/dɪ'lɪvər/	Delivered	/dɪ'lɪvəd/	Delivered	/dɪ'lɪvəd/
Demand	/dɪ'mænd/	Demanded	/dɪ'mændɪd	Demanded	/dɪ'mændɪd
Enjoy	/ɪn'dʒɔɪ/	Enjoyed	/ɪn'dʒɔɪd/	Enjoyed	/ɪn'dʒɔɪd/
Explore	/ɪk'splɔːr/	Explored	/ɪk'splɔːrd/	Explored	/ɪk'splɔːrd/
Feed	/fiːd/	Fed	/fed/	Fed	/fed/
Finish	/ˈfɪnɪʃ/	Finished	/ˈfɪnɪʃt/	Finished	/ˈfɪnɪʃt/
Flee	/fliː/	Fled	/fled/	Fled	/fled/
Help	/help/	Helped	/helpt/	Helped	/helpt/
Hope	/hoʊp/	Hoped	/hoʊpt/	Hoped	/hoʊpt/
Invite	/ɪn'vaɪt/	Invited	/ɪn'vaɪtɪd/	Invited	/ɪn'vaɪtɪd
Jump	/dʒʌmp/	Jumped	/dʒʌmpt/	Jumped	/dʒʌmpt/
Kick	/kɪk/	Kicked	/kɪkt/	Kicked	/kɪkt/
Listen	/ˈlɪsən/	Listened	/ˈlɪsənd/	Listened	/ˈlɪsənd/
Love	/lʌv/	Loved	/lʌvd/	Loved	/lʌvd/
Offer	/ˈɒfər/	Offered	/ˈɒfəd/	Offered	/ˈɒfəd/
Paint	/peɪnt/	Painted	/ˈpeɪntɪd/	Painted	/ˈpeɪntɪd/
Plan	/plæn/	Planned	/plænd/	Planned	/plænd/
Play	/pleɪ/	Played	/pleɪd/	Played	/pleɪd/
Return	/rɪ'tɜːn/	Returned	/rɪ'tɜːrnd/	Returned	/rɪ'tɜːrnd/
Share	/ʃer/	Shared	/ʃerd/	Shared	/ʃerd/
Shed	/ʃed/	Shed	/ʃed/	Shed	/ʃed/
Start	/stɑːrt/	Started	/ˈstɑːrtɪd/	Started	/ˈstɑːrtɪd/

Appendix G — Extended Prepositions Notes

[↑ Back to Chapter — 3. Prepositions](#)

- at + precise time or point: at 6 p.m., at the station.
- in + a larger period or area: in 1990, in London, in summer.

- on + a day or a surface: on Monday, on the table.
- Location vs. movement: use in/at for a static position, and into/to for active movement or direction.
- The Gerund Rule: any verb placed immediately after a preposition must take the -ing form (e.g. Thank you for helping, not for help).
- The to trap: in phrases like look forward to or object to, the word to is a preposition, not part of the infinitive — so it is followed by -ing: I look forward to seeing you.

Prepositions Summary

A quick side-by-side of noun-based possessive forms, with an example for each rule.

Preposition	General Usage	Verb + Preposition	Gerund Rule (Verb + -ing)	Scenarios & Contexts
About	Subject matter, topic, estimation, connection.	Think, worry, complain, dream, care, forget.	Worry about failing, dream about traveling.	Discussing a movie, worrying about exams, estimating an amount.
At	Specific points, exact addresses, precise times, locations.	Look, laugh, aim, arrive (at an airport), smile.	Good at drawing, bad at cooking.	Events (at a party), times of day (at noon), personal skills or performance.
By	Authorship, means of transport, method, physical proximity, deadline : by tomorrow.	Pass, stand, abide, replace, multiply.	Learn by doing, succeed by working hard.	Next to a window, traveling by car, books written by an author.
During	Throughout the course or duration of a period.	Used with nouns, not typically tied to specific verbs.	Not used with gerunds (followed by a noun instead).	Within a specific timeframe (during the movie, during the summer).
For	Duration of time, purpose, beneficiary, reason.	Wait, look, apologize, ask, blame, head.	Famous for singing, apologize for being late.	Exchanging goods (paying money), reasons for actions, searching for objects.
From	Origin, starting point, separation, source, cause.	Borrow, suffer, protect, prevent, graduate, recover.	Prevent from entering, suffer from losing.	Receiving a gift, distance between places, preventing negative outcomes.
In	Enclosed/ inside spaces, months, years, centuries, countries.	Believe, succeed, participate, involve, result.	Interested in learning, succeed in opening.	Inside buildings, future timeframes, expressing areas of interest.
Into	Movement toward the inside of something, transformation.	Change, turn, crash, run, dive, translate.	Tricked into buying and talk someone into going.	Entering a room, changing state (ice into water), accidents (crashing into a wall).
Of	Possession, belonging, material composition, cause.	Approve, die, consist, accuse, remind, suspect.	Accused of stealing, tired of waiting.	A cup of coffee, legal accusations, reminding someone of a memory.

Preposition	General Usage	Verb + Preposition	Gerund Rule (Verb + -ing)	Scenarios & Contexts
On	Surfaces, days of the week, specific calendar dates, on the phone	Depend On, rely On, congratulate, insist, comment.	Insist on paying, depend on winning. I need to congratulate you on doing such a great job.	Birthdays, public transport (bus, train), digital screens (TV, website).
To	Movement toward a direction, destination, or recipient.	Listen To, speak To, talk, belong, object, adapt.	I look forward to meeting, object to moving.	Transferring items, traveling to a city, expressing opposition to an idea.
With	Company (togetherness), instruments used, body features.	Agree, argue, compare, cope, share, provide.	Happy with winning, coping with managing.	Writing with a pen, discussing with a friend, handling a difficult situation.

Remember

- **The Gerund Rule:** Any verb placed immediately after a preposition must take the **-ing** form (e.g., *Thank you for helping*).
- **Location vs. Movement:** Use *in/at* for a static position, and *into/to* for active movement or direction.
- **The To Trap:** In phrases like *look forward to* or *object to*, the word *to* is a preposition, not part of an infinitive verb. Therefore, it must be followed by a gerund (e.g., *I look forward to seeing you*).

Prepositions in Details:

Ready to sound more professional? This is the full list of workplace verbs, with meaning, example and CEFR level.

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
About	Subject matter	Main topic of focus	The documentary is about deep-sea life.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
About	Topic	Conversational focus	Let's change the topic and talk about sports.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
About	Estimation	Approximate value	The flight will take about six hours.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
About	Connection	Link between things	There is something strange about this deal.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
About	Verb Combination	Think	I need a moment to think about your offer.	Yes (think about + -ing): I am thinking about moving abroad.
About	Verb Combination	Worry	You shouldn't worry about things you can't control.	Yes (worry about + -ing): Don't worry about making mistakes.

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
About	Verb Combination	Complain	Customers often complain about the long waits.	Yes (complain about + -ing): They complain about paying high taxes.
About	Verb Combination	Dream	I often dream about flying through the clouds.	Yes (dream about + -ing): She dreams about opening a bakery.
About	Verb Combination	Care	Good managers truly care about their staff.	Yes (care about + -ing): He doesn't care about winning anymore.
About	Verb Combination	Forget	Don't forget about the meeting tomorrow.	Yes (forget about + -ing): I forgot about locking the back door.
At	Specific points	Precise marker	Turn left at the traffic light.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
At	Exact addresses	Full address with number	The store is located at 55 Main Street.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
At	Precise times	Specific clock time	The movie starts exactly at 7:45 PM.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
At	Locations	General venue / activity	The kids are playing at the park.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
At	Verb Combination	Look	Please look at the projection screen.	Yes (look at + -ing): Stop looking at buying things you don't need.
At	Verb Combination	Laugh	It is not polite to laugh at someone's mistakes.	Yes (laugh at + -ing): We couldn't stop laughing at falling down.
At	Verb Combination	Aim	The marketing campaign is aimed at teens.	Yes (aim at + -ing): The strategy is aimed at increasing sales.
At	Verb Combination	Arrive	The train will arrive at the station soon.	No: Always followed by a location noun, never an action.
At	Verb Combination	Smile	She couldn't help but smile at the baby.	Yes (smile at + -ing): She smiled at remembering the old days.
By	Authorship	Created by	This classic novel was written by Charles Dickens.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
By	Means of transport	Vehicle style used	We prefer traveling across the country by train.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
By	Method	The way to achieve it	You can unlock the door by swiping this card.	Yes (by + -ing): You can pass by studying hard.
By	Physical proximity	Near / Next to	Our vacation cabin is located by the lake.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
By	Verb Combination	Pass	A police car just passed by our driveway.	No: Followed by location markers.
By	Verb Combination	Stand	Please stand by the door while I find the keys.	No: Followed by location markers or person nouns.
By	Verb Combination	Abide	Drivers must abide by the speed limits.	Yes (abide by + -ing): You must abide by wearing a helmet.
By	Verb Combination	Replace	Electric motors will replace gas engines by degrees.	No: Used in noun phrases in this context.
By	Verb Combination	Multiply	If you multiply five by four, you get twenty.	No: Followed by numbers/numerical nouns.
During	Throughout the course	Within the active period	The fans cheered loudly during the whole match.	No: Always followed by a noun, never a gerund.
During	Duration of a period	Spanning a timeline block	Many shops close down during the winter season.	No: Always followed by a noun, never a gerund.
For	Duration of time	Period length	The storm lasted for three continuous days.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
For	Purpose	The reason for an item	This special tool is for opening boxes.	Yes (for + -ing): This tool is used for cutting metal.
For	Beneficiary	Done to help someone	I made this hot soup for you.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
For	Reason	Motivation behind action	He received a medal for his bravery.	Yes (for + -ing): He was fined for parking illegally.
For	Verb Combination	Wait	We have been waiting for the bus since noon.	Not applicable (Noun scenario)
For	Verb Combination	Look	I am looking for my missing car keys.	No: Followed by target nouns/items being searched.

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
For	Verb Combination	Apologize	You must apologize for your behavior.	Yes (apologize for + -ing): I apologize for interrupting you.
For	Verb Combination	Ask	The customer came to ask for a refund.	Not applicable (Noun scenario)
For	Verb Combination	Blame	Do not blame others for your own faults.	Yes (blame for + -ing): They blamed him for losing the files.
For	Verb Combination	Head	Pack your bags, we are heading for the mountains.	No: Followed by destination nouns only.
From	Origin	Place of birth/creation	This delicious wine comes from Italy.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
From	Starting point	Initial physical mark	The race goes from the school to the river.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
From	Separation	Keeping apart	The fence separates our yard from theirs.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
From	Source	Where info/goods come	I got this useful advice from a book.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
From	Cause	Root of a condition	He is exhausted from working double shifts.	Yes (from + -ing): She is dizzy from spinning around.
From	Verb Combination	Borrow	Can I borrow a laptop from the office?	No: Followed by the source person/place noun.
From	Verb Combination	Suffer	Many people suffer from insomnia.	Yes (suffer from + -ing): He suffers from losing sleep regularly.
From	Verb Combination	Protect	Sunscreen helps protect your skin from burns.	Yes (protect from + -ing): This coat protects you from freezing.
From	Verb Combination	Prevent	A locked gate will prevent dogs from escaping.	Yes (prevent from + -ing): Good habits prevent you from failing.
From	Verb Combination	Graduate	She will graduate from university next May.	No: Followed by institution nouns only.
From	Verb Combination	Recover	It took him a week to recover from the flu.	Yes (recover from + -ing): He is recovering from breaking his arm.
In	Enclosed / inside spaces	Physical interior	The documents are in the safe.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
In	Months	Calendar month	We are planning a trip in September.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
In	Years	Specific year	The treaty was signed in 1995.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
In	Centuries	Historical era	Printing became common in the 15th century.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
In	Countries	Geographic nation	They bought a beautiful house in Italy.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
In	Verb Combination	Believe	You need to believe in your skills.	Yes (believe in + -ing): I believe in telling the truth.
In	Verb Combination	Succeed	They succeeded in finding a solution.	Yes (succeed in + -ing): She succeeded in passing the exam.
In	Verb Combination	Participate	Everyone should participate in the discussion.	Yes (participate in + -ing): Thank you for participating in organizing this.
In	Verb Combination	Involve (Passive)	She is heavily involved in charity work.	Yes (be involved in + -ing): He is involved in running the club.
In	Verb Combination	Result	Extreme stress can result in illness.	Yes (result in + -ing): Losing focus will result in making mistakes.
Into	Movement inside	Changing physical space	The dog ran out of the yard and into the house.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
Into	Transformation	State conversion	The wizard turned the small frog into a prince.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
Into	Verb Combination	Change	The old factory was changed into luxury apartments.	No: Followed by resultant state nouns.
Into	Verb Combination	Turn	With enough water, a desert can turn into a forest.	Yes (turn into + -ing): A casual talk can turn into arguing.
Into	Verb Combination	Crash	The out-of-control truck crashed into a concrete wall.	No: Followed by object nouns hit.
Into	Verb Combination	Run	I unexpectedly ran into my old teacher at the grocery.	No: Idiom meaning to meet someone by chance.

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
Into	Verb Combination	Dive	The athlete is preparing to dive into the pool.	Yes (dive into + -ing): Let's dive into explaining the rules.
Into	Verb Combination	Translate	Please translate this business letter into Spanish.	Yes (translate into + -ing): Ideas must translate into working harder.
Of	Possession	Owning or belonging	This is the property of the local church.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
Of	Belonging	Component of a whole	The wheels of the car were covered in mud.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
Of	Material composition	What something is made from	The historical crown is made of pure gold.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
Of	Cause	Root reason for death/state	The old oak tree died of a fungal disease.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
Of	Verb Combination	Approve	My strict parents do not approve of my hobbies.	Yes (approve of + -ing): I don't approve of gambling.
Of	Verb Combination	Die	The doctor said the patient did not die of old age.	No: Followed by disease or cause nouns.
Of	Verb Combination	Consist	The test will consist of fifty questions.	Yes (consist of + -ing): My routine consists of running and lifting.
Of	Verb Combination	Accuse	The police accused the suspect of theft.	Yes (accuse of + -ing): They accused him of cheating.
Of	Verb Combination	Remind	You remind me of a friend I had in school.	Yes (remind of + -ing): This reminds me of camping as a child.
Of	Verb Combination	Suspect	The guards suspect him of spying.	Yes (suspect of + -ing): They suspect her of stealing data.
On	Surfaces	On top of an area	The laptop is sitting on the desk.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
On	Days of the week	Specific day	The office is closed on Friday.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
On	Specific calendar dates	Day + Month / Date	The delivery will arrive on October 12th.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
On	On the phone	Communication medium	I cannot talk right now, I am on the phone.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
On	Verb Combination	Depend	Children depend on their parents.	Yes (depend on + -ing): Our plans depend on finding a hotel.
On	Verb Combination	Rely	You can always rely on her for help.	Yes (rely on + -ing): You can't rely on having good weather.
On	Verb Combination	Congratulate	We congratulated him on his promotion.	Yes (congratulate on + -ing): They congratulated her on winning.
On	Verb Combination	Insist	I insist on paying for the dinner.	Yes (insist on + -ing): He insists on driving us home.
On	Verb Combination	Comment	The director declined to comment on the rumors.	Yes (comment on + -ing): Avoid commenting on losing the match.
To	Movement toward direction	Heading somewhere	The compass points to the north.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
To	Destination	Final arrival goal	We walked all the way to the beach.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
To	Recipient	Target of an action	Send the completed file to the client.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
To	Verb Combination	Listen	You should listen to the instructions.	No: Followed by nouns/people. Action requires hearing (e.g. listen to him talking).
To	Verb Combination	Speak	I need to speak to the manager immediately.	No: Followed by pronouns or person nouns only.
To	Verb Combination	Talk	They spent hours talking to each other.	No: Followed by pronouns or person nouns only.
To	Verb Combination	Belong	Does this jacket belong to you?	No: Followed by pronouns or owners only (expresses possession).
To	Verb Combination	Object	Most members object to the new rules.	Yes (object to + -ing): I object to working overtime without pay.
To	Verb Combination	Adapt	Animals quickly adapt to climate changes.	Yes (adapt to + -ing): He had to adapt to living in a colder city.

Preposition	Scenario / Context	Specific Rule / Verb	Example Sentence	Gerund (-ing) and example
With	Company	Being alongside someone	I went to the concert with my brother.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
With	Instruments used	Tool to execute a task	You cannot cut wood with a butter knife.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
With	Body features	Physical traits	The man with the blue eyes is my uncle.	Not applicable (Noun scenario).
With	Verb Combination	Agree	I entirely agree with your assessment.	Yes (agree with + -ing): I don't agree with firing him.
With	Verb Combination	Argue	Please do not argue with the referee.	No: Followed by a personal noun.
With	Verb Combination	Compare	Do not compare your life with others.	Yes (compare with + -ing): Comparing buying a house with renting is tough.
With	Verb Combination	Cope	She is coping with managing a massive workload.	Yes (cope with + -ing): He is coping with living alone.
With	Verb Combination	Share	I am happy to share my food with you.	No: Followed by a recipient person noun.
With	Verb Combination	Provide	The hotel will provide guests with towels.	No: Followed by item nouns supplied.

Appendix H — Extended Gerund Notes

[↑ Back to Chapter — 10. Gerund vs. Infinitive](#)

- The gerund (-ing) behaves like a noun itself: I like shopping (shopping is the object of like).
- An adjective, by contrast, sits in front of a noun to describe it: a shocking news story.
- After a preposition, only the gerund is possible, never the infinitive: good at solving, interested in learning, responsible for finishing.
- Some verbs are followed by the infinitive instead (to + verb): decide to leave, want to help, promise to call.

Appendix I — Extended Possessives Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 6. Possessives](#)

Subject	Possessive Adjective	Possessive Pronoun	Example
I	my	mine	This is my laptop. / This laptop is mine.
You	your	yours	Is this your file? / Is this file yours?

He	his	his	That is his desk. / That desk is his.
She	her	hers	This is her report. / This report is hers.
It	its	—	The company updated its policy.
We	our	ours	This is our project. / This project is ours.
They	their	theirs	These are their tasks. / These tasks are theirs.

Possessive nouns:

Noun type	Rule	Example
Singular noun	add 's	the manager's office
Regular plural noun	add ' only	the employees' feedback
Irregular plural noun	add 's	the children's toys
Name ending in -s	add 's (or just ')	Charles's report / Charles' report

Appendix J — Extended Professional Words Table

[↑ Back to Chapter — 1. Start \(Professional / Workplace Vocabulary\)](#)

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
1	Adapt	to adapt (oneself)	The marketing team must adapt the business pitch for the new client.	B1
2	Adjust	to adjust / to fine-tune	To optimize our budget, we must adjust our marketing costs.	B1
3	Align / Allocate	to align / to allocate	We need to align the operations layout before the final deployment phase.	B2
4	Align on	to agree on / to reach agreement on	The executive department managed to align on the new product launch strategy.	B2
5	Align with	to align with / to comply with	Our internal radiology workflows must align with global compliance laws.	B2
6	Allocate	to allocate / to distribute	The finance director will allocate more funding to the HR department.	B1
7	Analyze	to analyze	We must analyze the quarterly performance data to identify why we lost those accounts.	B1
8	Analyze / Appoint	to analyze / to appoint (to a role)	After we analyze the performance, we will appoint a new project leader.	B2
9	Appraise / Approve	to appraise / to approve	The CEO needs to appraise the business plan before she can approve it.	B2
10	Approve	to approve / to validate	The legal department did not approve the initial terms of the contract.	A2
11	Architect	architect (systems/software)	He works as the lead architect for our enterprise medical imaging systems.	B1

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
12	Architect (verb)	to design / to structure	They are trying to architect a more efficient customer onboarding framework.	B2
13	Arrange	to arrange / to organize	The HR manager will arrange a meeting with the top candidates tomorrow.	A2
14	Articulate	to express clearly / to articulate	A good manager can articulate complex business strategies in a simple way.	B2
15	Assert	to state firmly / to assert	She needs to assert her authority to control the chaotic team meeting.	C1
16	Assert / Assess	to assert / to assess	We must assess the financial risks before we assert our presence in the market.	B2
17	Assess	to assess / to estimate	The committee will assess the economic impact of the corporate merger.	B2
18	Assess / Align with	to assess / to align with	Before we assess the project, we must align with the initial client brief.	B2
19	Audit	to audit / to check	External experts will audit our financial records next Monday morning.	B2
20	Audit / Automate	to audit / to automate	If we automate the billing system, it will be easier to audit accounts.	B2
21	Automate	to automate	We plan to automate customer service responses using an advanced AI tool.	B1
22	Balance	to balance / balance	It is difficult to balance aggressive business growth with staff well-being.	B1
23	Benchmark	to compare against a benchmark	We always benchmark our premium software prices against our rivals.	B2
24	Bottleneck	bottleneck / critical point	The slow approval process creates a severe bottleneck in product development.	B2
25	Bottleneck / Bug	bottleneck / bug (defect)	To avoid a system bottleneck, we must fix this critical software bug.	B2
26	Brainstorm	to brainstorm (exchange ideas)	The creative team will meet at 10 AM to brainstorm ideas for the campaign.	B1
27	Brand	brand / mark	We want to brand this product as a premium option for high-end corporate clients.	B1
28	Brief	to brief quickly / briefing	The project manager will brief the team on the client's strict requirements.	B1

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
29	Certify / Characterize	to certify / to characterize	The board will certify the system once auditors characterize it as secure.	B2
30	Check / Complaint	to check / complaint	Please check the customer database to make sure our workflow is fully compliant.	B1
31	Collaborate	to collaborate / to work as a team	Our graphic designers collaborate closely with the content creation team.	B1
32	Communicate	to communicate	Teams must communicate effectively instead of working in isolation.	B1
33	Compliance	compliance / adherence	The company hired a legal expert to monitor data protection compliance.	B2
34	Comply with	to comply with / to observe	Every employee must comply with the updated workplace safety regulations.	B2
35	Comply with / Coordinate	to comply with / to coordinate	You need to coordinate with IT to ensure all contracts comply with the law.	B2
36	Coordinate	to coordinate	The sales director will coordinate the upcoming international business launch.	B2
37	Core	core / essential	Customer satisfaction is at the core values of our current business model.	B1
38	Concentrate on	to concentrate on / to focus on	We must concentrate on expanding our market share instead of wasting time.	B2
39	Conclusion	conclusion	To conclude the corporate meeting, the director said we need to cut basic costs.	B1
40	Consequent	resulting from / consequence	The loss of a main client and the consequent revenue drop shocked the firm.	B2
41	Connected to	connected to / linked to	All marketing strategies are deeply connected to consumer behavior data.	B1
42	Consequently	consequently / as a result	Profits dropped drastically; consequently, management froze new hiring.	B2
43	Consistently	consistently	The senior designer consistently delivers top-quality vector assets on time.	B2
44	Consult	to consult / to ask advice	We should consult a financial expert before we purchase this new system.	B1
45	Convey	to convey / to express	The brand logo must convey a strong message of trust and innovation.	B2
46	Coordinate	to coordinate	The manager will coordinate the layout grid updates with the tech team.	B2

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
47	Coordinate / Debug	to coordinate / to debug (fix errors)	The IT team must coordinate their efforts to debug the server error quickly.	B2
48	Cost	to cost / financial cost	Delaying the product deployment will cost the company a lot of money.	B1
49	Create	to create / to generate	Our goal is to create an engaging onboarding program for new employees.	A2
50	Deadline	deadline	The deadline for submitting the final custom business proposal is Friday at 5.	B1
51	Decompose / Define	to decompose / to define	We need to decompose the large project into smaller tasks and define goals.	B2
52	Define	to define / to limit	The contract parameters define the exact responsibilities of each business partner.	B1
53	Delegate	to delegate (tasks)	A smart business executive should delegate regular tasks to his subordinates.	B2
54	Demonstrate	to demonstrate / to show	The sales data demonstration showed a clear need for a new retention strategy.	B1
55	Depict / Derive	to depict / to derive	These charts depict the growth we derive from our digital investments.	B2
56	Deployment	deployment / rollout	The sudden deployment of the new accounting software caused minor bugs.	B2
57	Describe	to describe	Can you describe the exact issue you had with our customer service tool?	B1
58	Describe / Diagnose	to describe / to diagnose	The client will describe the system glitch so our team can diagnose it.	B2
59	Design	to design / to conceive	We need to design a modern, user-friendly landing page for the startup.	B1
60	Detect	to detect / to spot	Specialized software can detect structural anomalies in digital print files.	B1
61	Develop	to develop / to expand	Our R&D department is trying to develop a better software architecture.	B1
62	Discrepancy	discrepancy / mismatch	Auditors found a major discrepancy between the physical stock and the report.	B2
63	Discuss / Document	to discuss / to put in writing	We must discuss the new policy changes and document them for the staff.	B2
64	Discussed	discussed / analyzed	We already discussed the core budget allocation during yesterday's session.	B1

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
65	Document	document / to document	It is essential to document every single customer complaint for quality control.	B2
66	Ensure	to ensure / to guarantee	Regular system audits will ensure total operational robustness.	B1
67	Employ / Enforce	to employ / to enforce (a rule)	If we employ more guards, we can enforce the new security safety rules.	B2
68	Engineer / Evaluate	to engineer (technically) / to evaluate	Our team will engineer a new network layout and evaluate its performance.	B2
69	Enforce	to enforce compliance	Implementing tight security tools will enforce better data privacy standards.	B2
70	Examine	to examine very closely	The board of directors will examine the merger proposal very carefully.	B1
71	Examine / Execute	to examine / to run or execute	We must examine the contract variables before we execute the final trade.	B2
72	Execute	to execute / to put into practice	The startup aims to establish a permanent presence in the Cairo business market.	B2
73	Evaluate	to evaluate / to gauge success	HR will evaluate the effectiveness of the training program next month.	B2
74	Evidence	evidence / clear proof	There is clear evidence that cross-functional workshops improve team collaboration.	B1
75	Facilitate / Fix	to facilitate / to fix	High emotional intelligence can facilitate discussions and help fix disputes.	B2
76	Export	to export	Our logistics firm plans to export agricultural products to European markets.	B1
77	Fix	to fix / to repair	The IT manager promised to fix the printing software error within an hour.	B1
78	Forecast	to forecast / to anticipate	Financial analysts forecast a 10% increase in corporate revenue next year.	B2
79	Forecast / Formalize	to forecast / to formalize	Once we forecast the profits, we can formalize our investment plan.	B2
80	Formalize	to formalize (in writing)	We need to formalize our verbal agreement into a binding business contract.	B2
81	Formulate	to formulate (a strategy/policy)	HR must formulate a new retention strategy to retain top tech talent.	B2

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
82	Furthermore	furthermore / in addition	The total restructuring was expensive; furthermore, it took three months.	B2
83	Given that	given that	Given that the client has a limited budget, we must offer an economic package.	B2
84	Govern / Harden	to govern (regulate) / to harden (secure)	New regulations govern how we must harden our data storage networks.	C1
85	Handy	handy / useful / practical	The sales team had hardly any free time during the peak onboarding season.	B1
86	Harmonize	to harmonize / to align	We must harmonize our local business goals with global corporate standards.	B2
87	Head to / Implement	to head to / to implement	As we head to a digital era, we must implement flexible work models.	B2
88	Highlight	to highlight / to bring into relief	The medical director used a red marker to highlight the flaw on the X-ray.	B1
89	Illustrate	to illustrate / to show by example	Let us use a simple pie chart to illustrate our quarterly marketing data.	B1
90	Implement	to implement / to put into practice	The company will implement a new remote-work policy starting this January.	B2
91	Imply	to imply / to suggest	Project delays do not necessarily imply a lack of dedication from the staff.	B2
92	Infer / Inform	to infer / to inform (announce)	Managers can infer employee satisfaction levels and inform HR of issues.	B2
93	Inspect / Instrument	to inspect / to instrument (equip technically)	Engineers will inspect the laboratory and instrument the new testing tools.	B2
94	Inspect	to inspect on site	The safety inspector arrived at the clinic to inspect the X-ray machines.	B1
95	Integrate	to integrate / to incorporate	The technical team managed to integrate the new CRM database successfully.	B1
96	Integrate / Isolate	to integrate / to isolate (an issue)	We must integrate new files while trying to isolate corrupted data tracks.	B2
97	Interpretation	interpretation (of data)	The financial director's interpretation of the market charts was highly accurate.	B2
98	Iterate / Justify	to iterate (repeat) / to justify with evidence	Designers must iterate system concepts, and they can justify the final layout.	B2

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
99	Justify	to justify / to demonstrate	The sales team must provide solid metrics to justify their high marketing budget.	B2
100	Lead to / Let you know	to lead to / to let you know	Software errors can lead to system crashes, but I will let you know if a bug occurs.	B2
101	Leverage	to leverage / to use to advantage	We should leverage social media analytics to attract new business clients.	B2
102	Leverage / Linked to	to leverage / linked to	To leverage growth, we must fix issues linked to poor product quality.	B2
103	Monitor	to monitor / to continuously oversee	High emotional intelligence helps managers monitor hidden conflicts in a team.	B1
104	Mention / Mitigate	to mention / to mitigate	Did you mention the technical risks? We must mitigate them immediately.	B2
105	Meticulously	meticulously	The legal team meticulously reviewed every clause in the insurance contract.	B2
106	Mitigate	to mitigate / to reduce risk	Client's flying portfolio is the best strategy to mitigate financial losses.	B2
107	Monitor / Normalize	to monitor / to normalize	Auditors will monitor transaction spikes to normalize the data stream.	B2
108	On the same page	on the same page (in agreement)	Before negotiating with the new client, our team must be on the same page.	B1
109	Optimize	to optimize / to streamline	We need to optimize our supply chain workflow to reduce general shipping days.	B1
110	Optimize / Outline	to optimize / to outline key points	We must optimize current cloud tools and outline the next security phase.	B2
111	Outline	to outline / to summarize briefly	Please create a brief presentation to outline the main business steps.	B2
112	Outline	to outline (list repetition)	(Repeated item in image) The proposal will outline the project scope clearly.	B2
113	Plan / Profile	to plan / to profile	We must plan our strategy after we profile our ideal corporate clients.	B2
114	Predict	to predict / to anticipate the future	It is difficult to predict exact market trends for the upcoming fiscal year.	B1
115	Predict	to predict (advanced level)	(Repeated item) Advanced AI tools can predict equipment failure rates accurate.	C1

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
116	Proactively	proactively	The account manager proactively contacted the client to resolve the system issue.	B2
117	Produce	to produce / to generate	Investing in high-quality X-ray systems will produce clear diagnostic images.	B1
118	Project	to project / to estimate figures	Financial officers project an increase in sales during the holiday season.	B2
119	Quantify / Rationalize	to quantify / to express in numbers	We cannot rationalize this executive budget if we cannot quantify the ROI.	B2
120	Reconcile	to reconcile / to bring into agreement	The accountant must reconcile the daily bank statements with our internal data.	B2
121	Reconcile / Refactor	to reconcile / to refactor	We must reconcile our design ideas and refactor the website user interface.	B2
122	Redundancy	redundancy / surplus	Eliminating structural redundancy helped the firm cut unnecessary running costs.	B2
123	Refactor	to refactor (code/design)	The software engineers will refactor the old code base to improve load speeds.	B2
124	Reiterate	to reiterate / to repeat for clarity	Let me reiterate that compliance with safety rules is non-negotiable.	B2
125	Reference / Related to	reference / related to	Minimal error rates are always directly related to performance rewards.	B1
126	Rely on / Report	to rely on / to report	Technicians rely on cloud systems to report scanner errors automatically.	B2
127	Reproduce / Resume	to reproduce / to resume	Once engineers reproduce the network bug, they can resume normal service.	B2
128	Review / Scrutinize	to review / to scrutinize thoroughly	Management will review the basic feedback and scrutinize specific complaints.	B2
129	Rigorously	rigorously / strictly	Every new batch of medical components is rigorously tested for quality.	B2
130	Robustness	robustness / resistance to shocks	The technical requirements of our server architecture prevent system crashes.	B2
131	Scope	scope / perimeter / area	Adding new features mid-project will completely alter the original scope.	B2
132	Scrutinize	to scrutinize closely (checking a list for errors)	Auditors will scrutinize corporate spending files during the annual audit.	B2

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
133	Show / Specify	to show / to specify clearly	The blueprint must show the core dimensions and specify the materials used.	B2
134	Simplicity	simplicity	The simplicity of the new user interface boosted user adoption rates by 30%.	B1
135	Specs	technical specifications	We need more desk space in the office to accommodate the new HR team.	B2
136	Streamline / Standardize	to streamline / to standardize	To stabilize output quality, we must standardize assembly line tasks.	B2
137	Standardize	to standardize	Our organization wants to standardize customer service workflows globally.	B2
138	Streamline	to streamline a process	We must streamline the reporting phase to reduce delivery times to patients.	B2
139	Structure	to structure / structure	The structural mechanics of the business setup are stable and strong.	B1
140	Subordinate	subordinate (employee)	We must provide clear data to substantiate your claims of market growth.	B2
141	Substantiate / Summarize	to substantiate with evidence / to summarize	Please summarize the main performance indicators and share them with clients.	B2/C 1
142	Sum up	to sum up / to recap	To sum up the meeting, we approved the budget and extended the deadline.	B2
143	Summarize	to summarize	At the end of the workshop, the mentor will summarize the core lessons.	B1
144	Support	to support / to provide backing	The management team promised to support the staff during the transition.	B1
145	Synthesize	to synthesize data	The market analyst will synthesize reports from multiple sources into one brief.	B2
146	Synthesize / Test	to synthesize / to test	Before the system deployment, engineers must test the automated workflows.	B2
147	The rest of / Trace	the rest of / to trace	IT experts will trace the network breach to find the root of the problem.	B1/B 2
148	To conclude / To sum up	to conclude / to sum up	To conclude the project was a success, and in sum up, we met all targets.	B1/B 2

#	Verb / Phrase	Meaning / Synonym	Example	L
149	Trace	to trace / to follow the steps	The data tracking software allows clients to trace deliveries live.	B2
150	Troubleshoot	to troubleshoot / to fix technically	Technicians arrived at the medical facility to troubleshoot the CT scanner.	B2
151	Validate	to validate / to officially confirm	The senior engineer must validate the system architecture before the launch.	B2
152	Validate / Verify	to validate / to verify compliance	Please check the financial records carefully to verify asset values.	B2
153	Verify	to check the data / to verify	Users can verify their digital medical records online via a secure portal.	B1
154	View	to view / opinion	Updating the CRM platform dramatically improved our sales team's daily workflow.	B1
155	Withdraw	to withdraw	The investment firm decided to withdraw its financial support from the project.	B2
156	Workflow	workflow / operational process	Updating the CRM platform dramatically improved our sales team's daily workflow.	B2